

Tropical Cyclone Pam (2015)

After Action Review of UNDP's Response

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List of Acronyms

AAR	After Action Review
BCPR	Bureau for Crisis Prevention and Response
BERA	Bureau for External relations and Advocacy
BMS	Bureau for Management Support
BPPS	Bureau for Policy and Programme Support
CB	Crisis Board
CERF	Central Emergency Response Fund
CfW	Cash for Work
CO	Country Office
CPRRV	Cyclone Pam Recovery and Resilience in Vanuatu
CRPs	Crisis Response Packages
CRT	Crisis Response Team
CRU	Crisis Response Unit
CSOPs	Corporate Standard Operating Procedures for Immediate Crisis Response
DFAT	Department of Foreign Affairs and Trade
DRR	Disaster Risk Reduction
ER	Early Recovery
EW	Early Warning
FTPs	Fast Track Procedures
GBV	Gender-Based Violence
GoV	Government of Vanuatu
HC	Humanitarian Coordinator
HCT	Humanitarian Country Team
HQ	Headquarters
IASC	Inter-Agency Standing Committee
IDPs	Internally Displaced Persons
ILO	International Labour Organization
MCO	Multi-Country Office
MSB	Myndigheten för samhällsskydd och beredskap (Swedish Civil Contingencies Agency)
OCHA	Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Action
PDNA	Post-Disaster Needs Assessment
PIP	Project Initiation Plan
RBAP	Regional Bureau for Asia and the Pacific
RC	Resident Coordinator
RH	Regional Hub
RM	Resource Mobilization
RR	Resident Representative
SOPs	Standard Operating Procedures for Immediate Crisis Response
TC	Tropical Cyclone
UN	United Nations
UNCT	United Nations Country Team
UNDAC	United Nations Disaster Assistance Committee
UNDP	United Nations Development Programme
UNICEF	United Nations Children's Fund
UNV	United Nations Volunteers
USD	United States Dollars
VHT	Vanuatu Humanitarian Team
WB	World Bank

Executive Summary

Introduction

UNDP conducted an After Action Review (AAR) of the response to Tropical Cyclone Pam in Vanuatu and Tuvalu in 2015. The cyclone brought widespread destruction: housing, infrastructure, agriculture, community and public facilities were damaged. Livelihoods, especially in the informal sector, were severely affected. UNDP mobilized the Multi-Country Office (MCO) based in Fiji and corporately to face the emergency. UNDP undertook immediate crisis response activities such as debris management, Cash for Work (CfW) and emergency livelihoods; it contributed USD 500,000 to the Cyclone Pam Recovery and Resilience in Vanuatu (CPRRV) plan. The organization was, however, not successful in mobilizing resources through humanitarian appeals or for recovery activities.

The AAR analyzes the response, documents enabling factors and good practices, and what can be learned to improve UNDP's future performance. It will inform the revision of the Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) for immediate crisis response and the finalization of the Crisis Response Packages (CRPs).

Analysis of the response

Before TC Pam, **UNDP's presence in Vanuatu** was limited to a National Officer – NOB level - based in the Joint UN Office. When the cyclone hit, UNDP had to scale up its presence and programmes very quickly: a special desk was established in Fiji MCO, staff rotated between Fiji and Vanuatu; UNDP opened an office in Port Vila. However, the Vanuatu office lacked a formally appointed Head of Office for the whole duration of the response. The multi-country nature of the office was the initial cause of the gap, but the organization collectively failed to recognize its importance and to address it. The absence of a Head of Office with the sufficient seniority, experience and representation authority heavily affected some key aspects of the response, in particular resource mobilization.

The Government of Vanuatu requested international assistance on the 15th of March and on the 16th a United Nations Disaster Assessment and Coordination (UNDAC) team deployed for three weeks. The Resident Coordinator was appointed Humanitarian Coordinator (HC) for three months.

After the cyclone, **UNDP mobilized corporately**: staff, resources and coordination mechanisms were activated in Fiji MCO, at the Regional Bureau/Regional Hub and at Headquarters. First responders and SURGE staff were deployed -depending on needs- to Fiji MCO, Vanuatu and Tuvalu. The immediate approval of Fast Track Procedures was helpful and appreciated: it contributed to avoid lengthy procedures. The funds released (USD 50,000 from RBAP and USD 350,000 from HQ) permitted to establish a more robust presence and capacity in Vanuatu and to set up the initial response.

UNDP's contribution to the Cyclone Pam Recovery and Resilience in Vanuatu (CPRRV) centered on two main types of activities: debris clearance and waste management, and livelihood interventions. In Tuvalu, work focused on debris and waste management as UNDP was not able to raise funds for the response and recovery in the country.

The Crisis Board (CB) met five times. Its role in bringing together different parts of the organization, channeling their support to the MCO through a unique and executive platform,

was essential for the management of the emergency. In order to anticipate and mitigate risks, the CB should conduct a Before Action Review (BAR) in one of its first meetings. The CB and CMT should also take early actions triggered by an early warning service every time there is a risk of a major disaster.

The **mobilization of first responders** was initially slow for multiple reasons, including engagement of potential first responders from the region in the Sendai conference, and adjustments or lack of clarity in the decision-making process for deployments after the corporate restructuring. The deployment of the first responders and of Stand-By Partner MSB was very much appreciated by the MCO and their quality recognized. However, the delay paired with limited capacity in country affected UNDP's response in the first days of the emergency, like its participation in the initial assessments, which in turn reduced the quality of the documents elaborated (for example the SURGE Plan and the CERF proposals, not based on assessments).

Experience shows that immediate presence and capacity to lead and deliver are key factors in crisis response and can heavily influence resource mobilization; a delay of even one day can have a major impact on the organizational outcome. The availability of financial resources affects programmes and an organization's capacity to deliver, thus it influences its performance, visibility and in the end its capacity to mobilize further resources for recovery and reconstruction.

SURGE Advisors were also deployed, after the first wave of corporate support. They included a Senior Recovery Advisor, initially planned for 1 month but in fact deployed for less time and with missions in between; an Early Recovery/Recovery Advisor, initially planned for 1 month, then extended on two occasions to a total of around 3.5 months; and a UN Coordination Specialist, deployed in Tuvalu for 3 months. Six more positions have been identified as part of the SURGE Plan.

The Early Recovery Advisor / Cluster Coordinator position was initially covered by a SURGE deployment, but this was fragmented and not replaced when it ended, and it should have started earlier. The ER Advisory function is very important immediately after the disaster, particularly in countries like Vanuatu where the Government might not be very knowledgeable about early recovery and therefore does not automatically consider it in its plans. In fact, many informants reported a general perception of insufficient dedicated technical guidance on ER. When planning crisis response and ER/Recovery phases, the CO shall reflect well on the strategic results the ER and Recovery functions should achieve, if pertinent linking the ToRs and deployments of the ER and Recovery Advisors.

The Recovery Advisor position was covered through a RH SURGE for about 3.5 months. During the deployment, the SURGE Advisor role transformed, also supporting the GoV in the recovery planning process, and coordination. As the disaster was relatively small, it was possible for one person to assume multiple roles, while normally it might be necessary to have two different deployments for livelihoods, PDNA and recovery planning.

The MCO should consider, in its preparedness plans and knowing the ER and recovery context in each country, what type of support and profile(s) would be more useful. These could be ER Advisors, PDNA Specialists, Livelihoods Advisors or others, or some position that covers multiple roles.

The contribution of local staff was positive: they assisted the technical experts and SURGE Advisors not only in communicating with people but who also advised them on the local context and how to adapt 'signature' solutions to the reality of the country.

In terms of **MCO performance**, the office was rapid in scaling up its response, but it was hindered by a lack of proper preparedness and the unfulfilled need for formal leadership that was already mentioned. Given the vulnerability of the area to disasters, and the multi-country nature of the office, a comprehensive preparedness plan is essential for the future.

In addition to increasing preparedness, UNDP should strive to better positioning the organization through programming. Considering potential response activities, the CO can structure regular programmatic interventions as potential entry points for crisis response.

UNDP should engage with the humanitarian community in country to position itself as a response and recovery actor; to raise awareness on Early Recovery and on its implications in humanitarian response and for recovery. Such constructive engagement is better pursued during non-disaster times, with Governments, partners, donors, so that when a disaster happens UNDP has already opened a channel of communication and possibly collaboration with them.

An important factor in successful response is the knowledge of corporate procedures, guidelines, support options from HQ and Regional Hubs. If already informed and trained, decision makers (RC/HC or Country Directors) can make better use of the different types of support available. Given the increasing vulnerability of countries to disaster, the growing frequency and severity of crises, UNDP should train all its RRs/RCs, Deputy RRs and Country Directors on the corporate approach and mechanisms for crisis response, early recovery and recovery.

Resource mobilization was unsuccessful. The organization was not able to mobilize funds from humanitarian sources and it missed direct opportunities with bilateral donors. UNDP intended to apply for CERF funds; its projects, however, were not accepted for final submission as not in line with "life-saving criteria". When funding was discussed with OCHA and other HCT members, UNDP did not have an authoritative representative with sufficient seniority, different from the RR/RC/HC; this reduced its voice and gravitas in discussions, ultimately contributing to the failure of its efforts. The initial Flash Appeal budget for early recovery was USD 2.3 million, of which USD 1.9 million for UNDP, later revised to 700,000; no funds were received.

The limited resources UNDP had for initial activities probably affected further funding opportunities: the organization had fewer operations, less visibility and a weaker position in the response. Resource mobilization for recovery focused on a Joint Programme with other UN agencies (ILO, UN Habitat, UN Women, UNV); the main targeted donor (DFAT) decided however to fund only one of the organizations.

The reasons for UNDP's failure in mobilizing external resources for response and recovery include both external and internal factors. Among the external or contextual factors are:

- Narrowness of the donor pool in the Pacific;
- The request from GoV that all funds be channeled through Government structures, reducing resources available for international organizations.

- Contextual circumstances: the region has a small population, is distant and isolated; which can make the emergency less “interesting”. In addition, with the Nepal earthquake a few weeks afterwards, many resources were diverted to this new crisis
- A perception among other actors that UNDP does not have a role in the immediate response (and therefore does not require funds); its activities might not be considered life-saving and the importance of early recovery might not be appreciated to the extent it deserves.

Internal factors include:

- The absence of a senior Head of Office in Vanuatu with the required authority and gravitas to represent the organization and advocate for resources in the negotiation with other HCT members.
- UNDP’s limited presence during initial assessments, a combination of the previous limited presence in Vanuatu, and the delays in the first deployments.
- Limited funds available to the MCO. If it had managed to access more resources, it would have had the opportunity for more activities, more presence and visibility, increasing its positioning and weight vis-à-vis Government and donors.
- Lack of awareness and knowledge on early recovery by the government and partners, particularly at the initial stage.
- Finally, a reported perception by donors of being considered merely funders and not partners

Programmatic activities were limited by the reduced resources. Planned activities in Vanuatu centered on local governance, cash for work, livelihoods restoration and resilience. In Tuvalu the response was limited to debris and waste management.

Cash for Work activities presented some challenges, as there was an initial resistance from local authorities and counterparts to adopt the CfW approach, despite its success in many emergency contexts. They feared an increase in dependency and the disruption of community practices. After consultations, UNDP successfully adapted the CfW approach to the local context.

Later on, the MCO developed a Joint Programme with other UN agencies. This choice, however, presented several difficulties. In addition to being a complex collaboration among UN agencies, ILO and UN-Habitat did not have a presence in country; a JP is not the best format for immediate response or early recovery, that require rapid implementation; as reported, activities were not always consulted properly with stakeholders; informants report that the JP presented some structural design weaknesses. The JP in the end was not funded and UNDP carried on the planned activities with PIP funds received from HQ.

Successes and challenges identified

Successes of the response and enabling factors

Corporate support (HQ and RH) and activation of crisis response mechanisms - Corporate support was convened quickly and it was dedicated and positive; with particular mention of the support provided by the Desk Officer in the Regional Hub. Activation of Fast Track Procedures and SOPs and release of immediate funds for Vanuatu were beneficial to kick-start the response. The CB effectively channeled support from multiple units and departments.

Immediate internal resource mobilization – Support from HQ and RBAP provided funds for USD 50,000, USD 350,000 and USD 476,000 (total of USD 876,000) which allowed the MCO to establish an office in Vanuatu and initiate immediate crisis response activities and coordination.

High quality and skills of staff deployed - Deployments provided UNDP with much needed capacity, particularly in Vanuatu; some of the staff deployed have been commended repeatedly as competent, knowledgeable and effective.

High quality and skills of MSB deployments – Ample consensus on quality and skills of the personnel deployed through MSB and their effectiveness even in short-term assignments.

Support provided by MCO staff – Positive contribution of local staff, advising technical experts on the local context and on how to adapt standard solutions to the reality of the country. Good collaboration between MCO staff and incoming responders. In particular, excellent performance reported of the Operations Manager deployed to Vanuatu, later recommended for SURGE deployments.

Rapid scale up of Vanuatu operation and stronger presence in country – Expansion of UNDP office in Vanuatu and establishment of a Vanuatu Special Desk in MCO, increase in staff and programme coherence and team work in Vanuatu, leading to a stronger operation and programme implementation.

Humanitarian leadership and Humanitarian coordination – Immediate appointment of the Humanitarian Coordinator and regular presence in country, positively recognized including by UNDAC. Strong support and civil-military coordination with FRANZ (France, Australia, New Zealand).

Challenges and gaps

Limited presence in Vanuatu and lack of senior representation in Vanuatu office – This was the key initial challenge faced by the MCO. A very limited presence before the disaster, and multiple factors afterwards led to a void in leadership and representation in Vanuatu, which affected in particular UNDP's representation and its resource mobilization efforts.

Lack of preparedness of the MCO – The Fiji MCO did not have a preparedness plan and was not ready to face the multiple challenges posed by TC Pam operation.

Delay in first responders' deployments – Competing engagements and some uncertainties on the new mechanisms following the corporate restructuring delayed the identification and deployment of first responders. This in turn affected the participation to assessments, the technical support to proposal development and resource mobilization, the time allowed for the elaboration of the SURGE Plan.

Limited continuity in SURGE support – Fragmented or short deployments, not replaced after departure, have limited the continuity of the support to the MCO, and in turn the continuity of UNDP's support to the country. In particular for Early Recovery, these issues and the high turnover led to a perception of insufficient technical guidance on ER.

Unsuccessful resource mobilization for humanitarian and recovery funds - The organization was not able to mobilize humanitarian funds. Reasons include the perception of limited UNDP's capacities as a crisis response actor, the classification of its activities as not "life-saving", the lack of an authoritative voice advocating for UNDP's proposals, and delays in

developing proposals for a bilateral donor. The external fundraising for the Joint Programme proposal for recovery activities also failed.

Limited knowledge of corporate crisis response and tools – Before TC Pam, some members of the MCO management and staff did not have extended knowledge of corporate crisis response, tools and resources available; training and an increased CO preparedness could have been beneficial.

Quality of programming – The gender equality approach in some of the proposals analyzed is limited; technical support from HQ or RH could have mitigated these difficulties. The Cash for Work approach appears to have been controversial at the beginning and not immediately accepted at local level; in the end, however, the MCO was able to adapt the approach to the local context.

Challenges linked to the context – The remoteness of the area and distance of islands caused difficult movements and a high cost of programming, even for a small emergency. The time difference affected communication and coordination with HQ and RH. After a few weeks, the earthquake in Nepal also diverted resources from other crises, including from the Pacific.

The Government of Vanuatu was very keen on taking the lead and having maximum visibility, in fact it requested that all funds be channeled through national structures. This limited the resources channeled through the UN itself, including UNDP. The focus on Vanuatu, who took the brunt of the cyclone, grossly limited any chances to raise funds and develop activities in Tuvalu, even if UNDP led the joint UN presence in Tuvalu, the government appealed for international support immediately and had a very positive relation with UNDP.

Conclusions and recommendations

This AAR concludes that UNDP's response to TC Pam was activated immediately and to the right degree both at corporate level and in country; however, some of the internal mechanisms for corporate support to the MCO – such as funds allocation and deployments – did not function as expected. The MCO structure and the absence of a preparedness approach had a negative impact on the response and on UNDP's capacity to mobilize resources, limiting *de facto* the possibility for significant recovery activities, once the initial emergency phase subsided. The initial response and immediate programme effort (in particular debris management) was successful, but it did not lead to medium and longer-term recovery engagement for UNDP.

Recommendations for UNDP

Resource Mobilization and Advocacy

- ✓ Treat RM as a high-level priority since the beginning of the response; include it as a standing agenda point in CB meetings, provide detailed guidance and resources to COs, for example with thematic RM packages within the CRPs
- ✓ Support the country offices with a RM Advisor as first responder (preferably deployed to the CO but if not possible, remotely) and a RM strategy, for all L2 and L3 crises;
- ✓ Review the existing mechanism to allocate immediate resources for crisis response to ensure its effectiveness and rapidity; consider a no-regrets approach for immediate release of funds;
- ✓ Profile donors: identify their funding priorities and interest, both thematic and geographic, preferred channels for funding (i.e. multilateral or bilateral); consider non-traditional donors (for example Russia, Kuwait, China, Kazakhstan); support COs by investigating and providing information on possible non-traditional resources;

- ✓ Engage with donors in non-disaster times, show UNDP's potential when it has sufficient resources (particularly on ER) and how this supports the entire response;
- ✓ Provide detailed guidance to COs on how to advocate for early recovery activities as life-saving, essential in the immediate response, or directly contributing to life-saving activities;
- ✓ Within the humanitarian system, stress UNDP's role in crisis management at global and (where necessary) country level; refine how the organization's role is presented and represented; discuss humanitarian funding criteria and how part of UNDP's activities fall under them.
- ✓ Conduct selected return on investment (ROI) analyses in next crises responses to identify the potential for resource mobilization of each initial response action (disbursement of funds via TRAC or PIP, deployment of first responders, direct RM investments and so on);
- ✓ Conduct an in-depth reflection, backed by research and data, on cost-opportunity for resource mobilization and engagement in early recovery rather than longer-term recovery and reconstruction, to determine an evidence-based position of the organization on the opportunity of each of them.

Immediate crisis support

- ✓ Include Before Action Reviews (BAR) in the new SOPs as a practice to be conducted within the first couple of CB meetings;
- ✓ Verify that any office in crisis has a Head of Office with sufficient seniority, preferably from the MCO. If this condition is not fulfilled, discuss with the MCO pertinent measures to address the gap;
- ✓ To facilitate coherence and coordination on the support HQ and Regional Hubs provide, identify focal points both at HQ and RHs on specific areas of work, like Local Governance, Livelihoods/Economic Recovery, Assessments including PDNAs/PCNAs, Interagency ER Coordination and others as pertinent;¹
- ✓ Clarify respective roles of BPPS, RH/RPPS, CRU and the Desk Officers in country support, to avoid duplications and potential conflicting advice, and to make stronger use of the resources available within the organization.
- ✓ Include in the new SOPs a mandatory review – around one month in the response – of the strategy, progress and challenges. The review should be a separate event (not a regular coordination meetings) to allow for proper reflection, and involve RH and HQ. The review should be repeated regularly, at least every three months.
- ✓ Include in the Crisis Response Packages a recommendation for rigorous assessment of the Cash for Work potential in each context and a recommendation for in-depth consultation with communities and local authorities to determine its viability and potential risks (such as disruption of existing social and community practices).

Deployments

- ✓ Include a Senior Recovery Advisor in the 'standard package' of First Responders in any crisis, as required expertise to support COs in conceptualizing and developing UNDP's role in the short, medium and long-term;
- ✓ Include Early Recovery Advisors in the First Responders standard deployment package, clearly identify their strategic contributions and reflect them in ToRs;
- ✓ Include in the first responders standard deployment package for MCOs a profile to support the MCO on non-affected countries, so that key staff can temporarily focus on the emergency; the same provision should be accorded to all COs when affected by a major crisis (automatically for L3 crises, upon decision for L2 crises);
- ✓ Provide incentives (for example on performance evaluation, or opportunities for professional development) to staff to be included in the First Responders Roster and incentives for staff and managers to ensure rapid deployment.

¹ Current draft of the new Corporate SOPs address this recommendation.

- ✓ Consider what measures are necessary to fulfill staff responsibilities in the office of provenance, when deployed on assignment (for example, funding a temporary replacement or providing temporary support from the Regional Hubs or neighbouring COs).

Preparedness and capacity building

- ✓ Institute a corporate policy of minimum CO preparedness, for low- medium- and high-risk countries. Minimum preparedness levels should be monitored annually and included as criteria for annual management evaluation.
- ✓ Establish an Early Warning service for HQ and RHs to alert key staff and offices/units of potential impending crises likely to reach L2 or L3 level.² Alternatively, adhere to similar services provided by other organizations (like GDACS, HEWS).
- ✓ Prepare for the possibility that multiple countries of an MCO are affected by a crisis, and that the MCO will require double/triple support in terms of first responders and SURGE deployments;
- ✓ Given the increasing vulnerability of countries to disaster, the growing frequency and severity of crises, train all RRs/RCs, Deputy RRs and Country Directors on the corporate approach and mechanisms for crisis response, early recovery and recovery; orient them on recovery coordination and global processes that unfold after disasters (e.g. Flash Appeals, CERF, PDNA).
- ✓ Develop simulations or scenario-based exercises presenting common challenges (for example advocacy and resource mobilization on early recovery in an unsupportive context, shifting or unclear government priorities on response and recovery, and others) to expose senior managers to these challenges and their possible solutions;
- ✓ In support to CO preparedness, provide guidance on potential strategic results in the immediate response phase (i.e. position UNDP as ER leader organization) and on required profiles, including mixed profiles, to achieve them;
- ✓ Develop in advance ToRs of likely profiles to be deployed (from stand-by partners, internal or external rosters) based on the typical team composition that can respond to the majority of disasters, include them in CRPs;
- ✓ Identify capable local staff in countries prone to emergencies, train them on crisis response rules and regulations and provide them with the knowledge and experience, through secondments or missions, to be 'assets' in crisis response in their own CO or as SURGE responders;
- ✓ Include soft skills as one of the selection criteria for first responders and SURGE Advisors deployment, and develop soft skills module as part of the First Responders and SURGE Advisors training;
- ✓ Develop an internal roster of debris management specialists, to be deployed as first responders until MSB experts arrive.

Recommendations for the Pacific Country Office (former MCO)

Preparedness

- ✓ Elaborate a preparedness and response plan, which includes:
 - Likely scenarios, such as disasters in one or more countries, and the different implications if the disaster is in Fiji or elsewhere;
 - Plans for multi-country / management level when a disaster strikes in one or more countries other than Fiji, and complementary brief individual response plans for each country;
 - A deployment plan of MCO staff to address the scenarios identified, with priority

² Included in the new draft SOP as one of the triggers for crisis board meeting #1 and crisis declaration.

given to a Head of Office and a coordination officer;

- A list of MCO “first responders” for immediate deployment and a second wave of staff, able to remain deployed for a longer time (at least 3-6 months);
- Surge support and profiles likely required (depending on the scenarios identified) and ToRs of potential surge; these could be ER Advisors, PDNA Specialists, Livelihoods Advisors or others, or some position that covers multiple roles; think strategically what results these profiles should achieve and develop draft ToRs accordingly;
- A joint plan with other UN agencies for representation in case of disaster where there is a Joint UN Presence;
- Preparedness and immediate response needs for Programmes and Operations
- Prepositioned supplies for crisis response packages (based on cost-benefit analysis);
- Stand-by agreements with partners for crisis response;
- Long Term Agreements with local suppliers, for materials and equipment sourced in local markets (as a complement or an alternative to pre-positioning);
- Training for staff and if pertinent for partners on crisis management, humanitarian programming cycle and early recovery.

Position UNDP for response and early recovery

- ✓ During non-disaster times, engage in dialogue, awareness raising and education of Governments, partners and donors on Early Recovery and its importance for crisis response;
- ✓ Engage with the humanitarian community in country (for example the Pacific Humanitarian Team, or the Vanuatu Humanitarian Team and other country-specific mechanisms), to position UNDP as a response and recovery actor, to raise awareness on Early Recovery and on its implications in humanitarian response and for recovery;
- ✓ Engage with country teams and governments to agree on the elements of a potential Early Recovery Cluster (e.g. national counterpart agency, member agencies of the ER cluster, programmatic mandate of the ER Cluster in terms of sectors and projects that it could undertake and so on);
- ✓ Position the organization for disaster response through programming. When designing regular programmes and projects, take into consideration the likely disaster scenarios and crisis response and recovery needs; reflect on how to align or adapt programme activities so that they could be converted or built-upon in crisis response, early recovery and recovery (for example a regular programme on waste management, can be converted to an emergency response project on debris management);
- ✓ Map existing programmes for potential entry points on crisis response and in case of disasters, use these entry points to kick-start the response.

Resource mobilization

- ✓ Engage with donors locally, during non-disaster times, to show UNDP’s role and potential in emergencies and how it can contribute to response and early recovery;
- ✓ Discuss with donors about RM that takes place in the first weeks after a disaster but it should not be only about immediate crisis response; open a dialogue on the linkages with long-term recovery and how to connect RM for the two phases;
- ✓ Agree with donors when designing programmes what resources can be used for immediate disaster response in case of an emergency (ex. 5% of the total or similar).

During response

- ✓ At the beginning of the response, conduct a brief “Before Action Review” to identify the most important risks the operation could face (See How to conduct a BAR in Annex 6.6) and how to mitigate them;
- ✓ Ensure the immediate deployment (if capacity is not sufficient in country) of a Head of Office and a Coordination Specialist; consider the need for a Resource Mobilization Advisor;

- ✓ Ensure the immediate deployment of an Early Recovery Advisor (if capacity is not sufficient in country) with clear strategic and programmatic goals reflected in his/her ToRs;
- ✓ Strengthen credibility as a response actor: consolidate the image and work of UNDP on the ground, develop a solid conceptual and operational approach in the response, document it and share it, demonstrate to Governments, partners and donors that the organization can deliver;
- ✓ Deliver key messages to media and external stakeholders on the role of UNDP in crisis response;
- ✓ Conduct a review – around one month in the response – of the strategy, progress and challenges; review if initial ToRs of staff deployed, surge and consultants are still relevant or if they should be updated, ensure that any changes are communicated to all staff. Conduct the review as a separate event (not as a regular coordination meetings) to allow for proper reflection, and with the participation of the RH and HQ. Repeat the review regularly, every three months at least.

1. Introduction

UNDP's Strategic Plan (2014-2017) recognizes the importance of preparedness, response, early recovery and risk management as fundamental for resilience building and development. The organization is committed to improve its performance in crisis response and recovery, and to become faster, more predictable and more effective. Two initiatives in particular reflect this commitment: the development of **Crisis Response Packages (CRPs)**, and the corporate review of the **UNDP Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) for crisis response**.³

UNDP routinely analyzes its performance in crisis response and recovery, through different tools like evaluations and **After Action Reviews (AARs)**. AARs are critical exercises to improve efficiency and effectiveness. They foster reflection on the response and the identification of lessons on what happened and why, what was learned, what follow-up action should be taken and how to do better next time. The purpose of AARs is to inform future actions by identifying lessons and actionable recommendations.

With this aim in mind, the organization conducted an AAR of the **response to Tropical Cyclone Pam in 2015**. A Category 5 cyclone, Pam struck the 22 islands of **Vanuatu**, bringing widespread destruction and affecting about 166,000 people. The assessment conducted in **Tuvalu** indicated damages and losses equal to the 7.5% of its Gross Domestic Product (GDP). Housing, infrastructure, agriculture, community and public facilities were damaged. Livelihoods, especially in the informal sector, were severely affected. UNDP mobilized the Multi-Country Office (MCO) based in Fiji and corporately to face the emergency. The Crisis Board (CB) met, Fast Track Procedures (FTPs) were activated and immediate funds were released to start the response; First Responders and SURGE staff deployed to Fiji MCO, Vanuatu and Tuvalu. UNDP undertook immediate crisis response activities such as debris management, Cash for Work (CfW) and emergency livelihoods; it contributed USD 500,000 to the Cyclone Pam Recovery and Resilience in Vanuatu (CPRRV) plan. The organization was, however, not successful in mobilizing resources through humanitarian appeals or for recovery activities.

The purpose of this Review is to analyze and document the successes, enabling factors and gaps and challenges of the response, to improve UNDP's future performance in the MCO itself and globally as an organization. The AAR outcome will inform the revision of the SOPs for immediate crisis response, the revision of the Fast Track Procedures and the finalization of the Crisis Response Packages (CRPs).

The **AAR Report** is organised in six parts: the *Introduction* and the explanation of the *Methodology* precede an *Analysis of the response*, which describes key elements such as management, resource mobilization, and programmes. The *Timeline of events*, included in the Annexes, complements this chapter. The following one, *Successes and Challenges of the Response*, highlights the positive elements that have contributed to the response and its main achievements, as well as the gaps and difficulties encountered. Finally, the report presents *Recommendations* to be taken forward by the organization and by the MCO.

³ To distinguish the two versions of the Standard Operating Procedures, in this report the 2012 SOPs (Standard Operating Procedures for Immediate Crisis Response) will be called "SOPs" while the version under development (Corporate Standard Operating Procedures for Immediate Crisis Response) will be called "Corporate SOPs" or "CSOPs".

2. Methodology

The AAR was conducted remotely. Its objective was to reveal what elements contributed to or limited the response, while taking into consideration the SOPs revision and the finalization of CRPs; the methodology and the conventional questions of an AAR⁴ were adapted to reflect this. An initial **desk review** preceded a **Focus Group Discussion** (FGD) with HQ staff⁵ to identify key issues for the AAR and to complement the methodology.

The **consultations with the Fiji MCO, staff and consultants** involved in the response were remote as well; the **individual interviews**⁶ served for data collection and in-depth discussion of the key issues. The preliminary research phase resulted in the “**Initial findings**”, shared with all AAR participants and now integrated in this Report.

The **AAR took place** in two parts, because of the time difference among all countries involved: a **first AAR** took place with HQ-based staff on the 22nd April 2016, and a **second AAR** took place with Asia-based staff on April 25th⁷. During the AARs, participants validated the Initial findings and discussed key elements of the response, including management (corporate support, deployments and crisis response at Fiji MCO), resource mobilization, programmes, and CO preparedness. To maintain coherence between the two AARs, the same guidelines and list of questions were used.⁸

The outcomes of the AAR are documented in the present **Final Report**.

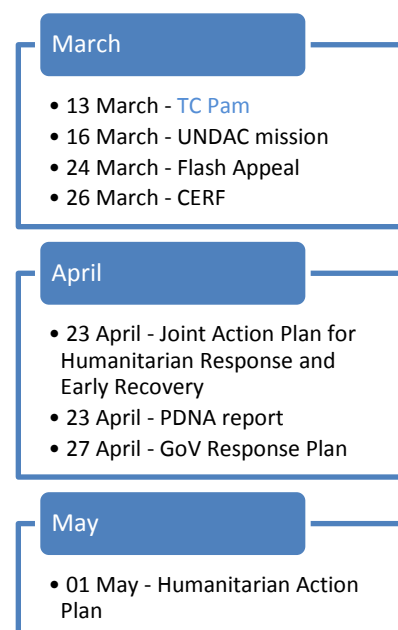
3. Analysis of the response to TC Pam

3.1. Context and background

On 13th March 2015, Category 5 Tropical Cyclone (TC) Pam struck the 22 islands of **Vanuatu**, bringing widespread destruction. The cyclone affected about 166,000 people out of the estimated national population of 277,000. Communities suffered extensive damages and losses to housing, infrastructure, and agriculture; to water, community and public facilities, community orchards, trees and plantations. Formal and informal sector livelihoods were severely affected.

The Rapid Needs Assessment conducted by the Government of Vanuatu (GoV) indicated that in the most affected islands, shelter was wiped-out up to 100% and roads were impassable because of the debris. The rapid loss and damages assessment conducted by the World Bank (WB) indicated that **Tuvalu** lost 7.5% of its Gross Domestic Product (GDP). Both Vanuatu and Tuvalu’s populations rely strongly on subsistence farming and fisheries for food security and livelihoods. The destruction

Figure 1: Key dates



⁴ What happened, what was supposed to happen, what went well, what could have gone better, what to do differently next time?

⁵ See Annex 02 for the list of participants.

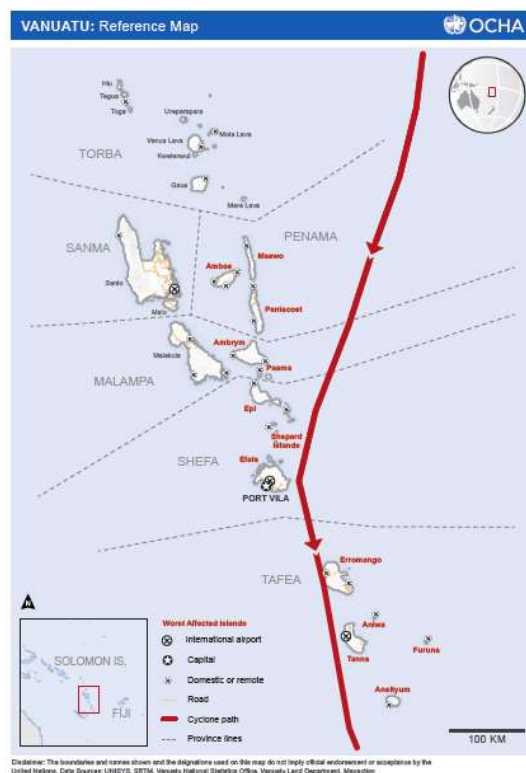
⁶ See Annex 02 for the list of people interviewed.

⁷ See Annex 02 for the complete list of participants.

⁸ See the Guidelines for the AAR in Annex 02.

of food gardens and the loss of livestock left households with no alternative food sources. The loss of crops and severe damage to coffee and sandalwood plantations destroyed the main sources of income, with a significant long-term social and economic impact for the population. Women, already more likely to be living in poverty, were among the most affected. They had more precarious income sources, and carried a disproportionate burden of family care responsibilities, worsened by the impact of the cyclone.

Figure 2: TC Pam path



The international community immediately intervened supporting the Governments of Vanuatu and Tuvalu. UNDP Fiji MCO was among the many international and national actors involved: the key steps of the response by UNDP and other organizations are detailed in Annex 6.4 – Timeline of events.

At the time, the Fiji MCO covered 10 countries: Federated States of Micronesia, Fiji, Kiribati, Marshall Islands, Nauru, Palau, Solomon Islands (where it had a sub-office), Tonga, Tuvalu and Vanuatu. Before Cyclone Pam, UNDP only had a National Programme Analyst (NOB) in Vanuatu, in the Joint UN Office, and no staff was based in Tuvalu. This challenged the absorption capacity of the MCO, as it had to scale up the programme very rapidly in Vanuatu (and to a minor extent in Tuvalu), had to establish an office in Vanuatu, and simultaneously supported the operational expansion with the arrival of first responders and SURGE staff. Today, through the Joint

Presence initiative, UNDP has a presence in Kiribati, Palau, Tonga, Tuvalu and Vanuatu.⁹ The MCO has been merged with the Pacific Centre and its regional programmes, and is now called the Pacific Office in Fiji and between the former MCO and the regional programmes, 15 countries are covered. In the present report, its name at the time of the disaster (MCO) will be maintained to avoid any confusion.

3.2. Management of the immediate crisis response

3.2.1. A note on UNDP MCO structure and presence in Vanuatu

Before TC Pam, **UNDP's presence in Vanuatu** was limited to a National Officer – NOB level – based in the Joint UN Office. UNICEF provided representation for non-resident UN agencies (while in a similar agreement, in other countries in the region UNDP represents UNICEF and other agencies). When the cyclone hit, UNDP had to scale up its presence and programmes very quickly, starting crisis response activities, receiving First Responders and SURGE staff.

A special desk was established in Fiji MCO, Operations staff rotated between Fiji and Vanuatu; in addition, one Operations Manager was deployed to Vanuatu. UNDP opened an office in Port Vila, leading to better programme coherence and teamwork, and easier programme

⁹ UNDP Fiji MCO website http://www.fj.undp.org/content/fiji/en/home/operations/about_undp.html

implementation. However, the Vanuatu office lacked a formally appointed **Head of Office** for the whole duration of the response.

Due to the multi-country nature of the office, senior management leadership of the response was not as targeted as it could have been. The RR/RC became Humanitarian Coordinator (HC), which was the case for TC Pam just a few days after the disaster, and assumed the responsibility for coordination and representation of the entire humanitarian community, including UN agencies and NGOs. Opportunities for the RR/RC/HC to advocate for the interests of UNDP were therefore limited. In a situation like this, the Deputy RR assumes an important role to ensure the representation of UNDP among UN agencies and within the context of the humanitarian response. Yet, the MCO nature of the office made this task particularly difficult: the Deputy RR also had the responsibility to attend to the other countries, and when the RR/RC/HC was in Vanuatu, the Deputy RR remained in Fiji. This deprived the Vanuatu office of a UNDP senior representative – particularly during fund negotiations – and the gap was never structurally addressed. On occasions, this role became part of the responsibilities of the positions covered by consultants or stand-by partners, who do not always have the experience and previous exposure to such functions.

In addition, concomitant with the cyclone both the RR and Deputy RR traveled or were already on planned missions. The RR shortened her trip to return to Fiji/Vanuatu in advance, arriving in Vanuatu on the 17th March, while the Deputy RR traveled to Tonga from 17th to 19th to chair the Tonga Governance Strengthening Programme meeting. According to the information reported, the meeting was politically very sensitive as the programme had received sudden notice of premature funding termination from the donors, and needed to be managed at senior level.

While the circumstances were not favourable (RR on mission, an important programme in peril in another country, no CD in Vanuatu), it is important to keep in mind that the absence of UNDP in the first days after the disaster can be perceived by authorities, partners and donors as an indicator of unresponsiveness. This can be very damaging for UNDP's image. To mention a frequently cited example, UNICEF was able to deploy staff from the regional office even before the cyclone hit, it was immediately present on the ground and rapid in establishing a response, which was instrumental in receiving major funding from donors.

The absence of a Head of Office with the sufficient seniority, experience and representation authority has heavily affected some key aspects of the response, in particular resource mobilization. The organization collectively failed to recognize the importance of this gap and to address it, and rather adopted a piecemeal approach that in the end did not function.

Since UNDP has other MCOs in the Pacific and in the Caribbean, and might extend this model to other offices, it should learn from TC Pam experience and identify a clear mechanism to avoid such gap in the future. The best solution lies in CO preparedness: MCOs in countries and regions that are prone to disasters should identify and test suitable mechanisms for the deployment in the area affected, for a sufficient length of time (at least 3 months, ideally more) of a staff member with the required seniority, UNDP experience, knowledge of the country programme, and representation capacity. In addition, the MCO should foresee scenarios in which multiple countries are affected by the disaster – as it is often the case in the Pacific – and where it needs to increase its presence and representation simultaneously in multiple countries, while at the same time maintaining the rest of its programmes in the MCO. Many options are possible, but they should be identified and agreed *before* a crisis happens.

3.2.2. Overview of the immediate crisis management in the Pacific

When TC Pam hit Vanuatu, the devastation was massive. The **Government of Vanuatu** requested international assistance on the 15th of March and on the 16th a **United Nations Disaster Assessment and Coordination (UNDAC)** team deployed for three weeks to support the national authorities and the Vanuatu Humanitarian Team (VHT) in information management, assessments, resource mobilization and civil-military coordination. On March 17th, The Resident Coordinator was appointed Humanitarian Coordinator (HC) for three months.

The **clusters**, adopted back in 2011, were activated for the response. Line ministries led them with support of VHT co-leading agencies. In addition to the pre-existing clusters (logistics, shelter, food security and agriculture, education, health and nutrition, WASH, protection and gender), the working groups focused on information management and assessment, Internally Displaced Persons (IDPs), emergency telecommunications, infrastructure, disability, gender and GBV. There was no Early Recovery cluster.

Australia, Fiji, France, New Zealand, and others sent military assets, which proved critical in the initial response. They helped in overcoming the large distances and the difficulties in transport and communications, exacerbated by the cyclone destruction.

UNDP mobilized corporately: staff, resources and coordination mechanisms where activated in Fiji MCO, at the Regional Bureau/Regional Hub and at Headquarters.¹⁰ **UNDP Fiji Multi-Country Office (MCO)**, which covered both Vanuatu and Tuvalu, scaled up the programme in Vanuatu, while at the same time supporting the operational expansion through the new special desk for TC Pam response.

First responders and SURGE staff were deployed -depending on needs- to Fiji MCO, Vanuatu and Tuvalu. Between the 17th and the 22nd of March, the organization mobilized:

- A Recovery Adviser from Fiji MCO/Pacific Centre deployed and reassigned to Tuvalu for 3 months;
- A DRR/Recovery Adviser from the Middle East Regional Office, assigned to Fiji MCO for 2 weeks;
- The Programme Coordinator of the Pacific Risk Resilience Programme, deployed to Vanuatu for 1 week.

Other first responders, SURGE staff and staff from the Stand-by Partners rosters arrived in the following days and weeks;¹¹ operations, logistics and procurement staff rotated from Fiji MCO in Suva to Port Vila on a weekly basis, to support the operation.

Fast Track Procedures were requested and approved, and the Regional Bureau for Asia and the Pacific (RBAP) allocated USD 50,000 for the immediate needs of the office.

The RC/HC often traveled to Vanuatu to lead the humanitarian response. The Flash Appeal was launched on the 24th March, and the CERF on the 26th. On the 23rd of April both the Joint Action Plan for Humanitarian Response and Early Recovery and the Post-Disaster Needs

¹⁰ Many of the processes and actions described in chapter 2 took place at the same time in different locations, but they are described separately to facilitate the analysis. The timeline in Annex I provides a chronological account of the main events.

¹¹ Deployments are discussed more in detail in Chapter 3.2.3

Assessment (PDNA) report were launched. On April 27th, the Government of Vanuatu launched its Response Plan.

UNDP's contribution to the Cyclone Pam Recovery and Resilience in Vanuatu (CPRRV) centered on two main types of activities: debris clearance and waste management, and livelihood interventions. The debris clearance and waste management component focused on the two municipalities of Port Vila and Lenakel and included:

- Removing debris and all forms of waste (green waste, solid waste, metals and white waste) in Port Vila and Lenakel Town;
- Salvaging logs from fallen trees (regarded as waste) to produce useful timbers for communities;
- Removing debris and fallen woods on coffee plants caused by TC Pam as a means of livelihood support.

Debris clearance was successfully carried out, under the supervision of MSB Waste Management experts, with labour provided through an emergency employment scheme. The Emergency Employment Scheme (EES) program provided cash for participants to support them in their immediate needs such as food, clothing, and medicines, and benefited whole communities. A total of 129 people were recruited for the EES in the two municipalities (of which 57% male and 43% female).

In Tanna, UNDP worked with a local NGO to salvage fallen logs and turn them into timber that could be used to rebuild houses. This also reduced the risk of fire hazard and cleared land for planting crops. Beneficiaries were trained in the use of sawmills, so that timber waste could be recycled and put to use either for individuals or the community (for example to repair community infrastructures).

In Tuvalu, work focused on debris and waste management as UNDP was not able to raise funds for the response and recovery in the country. The sectorial funding needs were calculated at AU\$ 4 million, but no pledges were made against these requirements. UNDP contributed 3 technical advisors for Early Recovery, Debris Management and Donor Coordination. The main activities realized include:

- An assessment of the situation of debris and waste in Tuvalu
- Project design and resource mobilization through a Project Initiation Plan (PIP), which in the end was not funded
- Support for the development of a sectorial recovery plan for debris and waste management
- Support to the operational planning and monitoring of debris clearance and waste collection activities, including training and development of tools.

3.2.3. Corporate support to Fiji MCO

3.2.3.1 Crisis Board (CB) and corporate mechanisms for crisis response

In case of a major emergency,¹² UNDP's Standard Operating Procedures for Immediate Crisis Response (the 2012 SOPs)¹³ require that the **corporate mechanisms** be activated straightaway. The organization designated TC Pam crisis as **Level 2** and initiated SOPs, Fast Track Procedures, and the mobilization of the Crisis Board.

The **Crisis Board (CB)** met five times, the first time on the 16/17th March¹⁴ and then once a week afterwards. As the organisation agreed on an L2 crisis, RBAP chaired the CB virtual meetings among New York, Bangkok, Suva and Port Vila. The key decisions of the five meetings are summarized below:

- *CB1 (16/17 March): Agrees on L2 crisis. Importance of highlighting early recovery and including it in funding appeals; lessons learned from Philippines: if the resource mobilization opportunity is missed, there is no second round. Requests MCO to identify additional resources needed. Agrees on USD 50,000 from RBAP for immediate expenses; agrees on Fast Track Procedures approval; requests TRAC 3 proposal for 19/03 and two pagers for Japan by 20/03.¹⁵*
- *CB2 (23/24 March): Requests proposal for seed funds to BPPS; highlights possible concerns with PDNA; confirms allocation of USD 50,000 by RBAP and USD 350,000 on TRAC. Requests SURGE Plan by next CB meeting. Takes note of the support requested by MCO:*
 - *Vanuatu: Senior Recovery Advisor for 3 months;*
 - *Vanuatu and Suva: Programme Specialist to prepare and implement Flash Appeal project on recovery (UN Joint Programme);*
 - *Vanuatu: UNDP Head of Office to also cover representation, donor relations, inter-agency etc. and help establish UNDP office for 3 -6 months, to be converted into regular post funded from recovery projects in the future;*
 - *Tuvalu: Senior Recovery Advisor who knows UNDP and can also handle UN coordination for potential Flash Appeal for 3 months;*
 - *Tuvalu: Debris Management Specialist (3-4 weeks) (can be consultant or from roster);*
 - *Suva: Detail assignment to support MCO programmes in remaining 8 countries.*
- *CB3 (31 March/01 April): Approves the first draft of SURGE Plan, with some revisions (final version dated 15 April); requests to Fiji MCO to develop and share concept notes for resource mobilization. Decides to establish Crisis Management Team. Requests for a PIP proposal for Tuvalu to be submitted to BPPS. Recommends including longer term livelihoods restoration, beyond debris management, Cash for Work (CfW) and service delivery by local governments.*
- *CB4 (9/10 April): Agrees to deploy RH/BPPS Advisors to ensure UNDP positioning in Early Recovery and livelihoods as foundation for long-term recovery, support the PDNA, finalize UNDP recovery vision paper and respond to GoV request for technical advice on Economic Recovery; they will also help MCO in finalizing 2 pagers for resource mobilization. Requests BPPS to provide feedback on Tuvalu PIP document. SURGE Plan to be reviewed with additional deployments agreed.*

¹² See 2012 SOPs Para.32 and following for details on the triggers and activation sequence of UNDP crisis response.

¹³ Crisis Response SOPs are currently under review. For ease of reference, the SOPs existing at the time of TC Pam, endorsed in 2012, are called "2012 SOPs" while the ones under review and to be approved and implemented in 2016 are called "new SOPs".

¹⁴ Because of the time difference, meetings were held usually on the evening in New York, which was the following day in Asia.

¹⁵ It appears from the information reported (but there is no written record) that by this time, the RM window with Japan was already closing, as it required an initial funding proposal in 2 or 3 days and when UNDP's one was ready, it was too late. Funds were allocated to UNICEF.

- *CB5 (23/24 April): Agrees to end CB meetings¹⁶ unless requested by MCO or HQ; extends deployment of one RH/BPPS Advisor; several resource mobilization meetings planned for BERA and HC; separate BPPS MCO discussion to take place with MCO on Tuvalu PIP.*

The immediate approval of Fast Track Procedures was helpful and appreciated: it contributed to avoid lengthy procedures. The funds released (USD 50,000 from RBAP and USD 350,000 from TRAC 1.1.3 Cat. II for emergency response coordination and assessments) permitted to establish a more robust presence and capacity in Vanuatu and to set up the initial response.

The CB role in bringing together different parts of the organization, **channeling their support to the MCO** through a unique and executive platform, is essential for the management of a major emergency.

Drawbacks and challenges are common in crisis response; one simple yet effective tool to anticipate and mitigate risks is the **Before Action Review (BAR)**. A BAR is an exercise that helps a team in detecting possible risks and challenges a project or programme may face and in identifying and prioritizing measures to manage the risks.¹⁷ The BAR would also help the CB and COs involved in crisis response to capitalize on lessons learned from the past. The BAR should be conducted within the first couple of CB meetings and included in the new SOPs. To some extent, this is already done – the first CB meeting on TC Pam did anticipate resource mobilization risks – but a more structured approach would systematize it and ensure its implementation. When AARs are conducted at the end of a crisis response, the corresponding BAR should also be reviewed to see how effective the organization was in predicting major risks and avoiding or mitigating them, and what it can learn from the experience.

The TC Pam response shows some areas for improvement. Cyclone Pam struck on a Friday evening local time, but there was some **early warning**.¹⁸ The first CB was next Monday (EST)/Tuesday (Pacific time), three and a half days after the event. The SOPs (Para. 38) require that the initial crisis management meeting takes place *within 48 hours* of the initial alert communication by the Regional Director, BCPR Director¹⁹ or RR/RC.

The Bangkok desk had informed of the approaching cyclone but no significant **early actions** were taken either at MCO or HQs. Experience shows that immediate presence and capacity to lead and deliver are key factors in crisis response and can heavily influence resource mobilization; a delay of even one day can have a major impact on the organizational outcome. It is not possible to determine if an earlier mobilization of the CB would have led to better results; however, given the extremely fast pace of the first days – particularly on resource mobilization opportunities – early action does not hurt.

It would be useful for UNDP both at central and regional hub level to introduce a formal Early Warning service, to alert key staff and structures in the organization of potential impending crises likely to reach L2 or L3 level. The organization should evaluate the opportunity of developing an EW service internally, or adhering to similar services provided by other organizations (like GDACS, HEWS and similar). An EW service, an immediate first CB meeting

¹⁶ One informant raised the issue of information sharing after the end of the CB. When CB ends, HQ technical support reduces (or ends), and there is no regular information about possible technical support needs. It was suggested to have one or more working-level inter-Bureau meetings after the CB ends, to review the situation and determine if any further support or advice can be provided from RH and HQ.

¹⁷ Annex 6.6 includes indications on how to conduct a Before Action Review.

¹⁸ Although cyclone paths are unpredictable, maps show that between 24 and 18 hours before it hit, it deviated more pronouncedly towards the islands.

¹⁹ BCPR does not exist anymore; the new SOPs will indicate an updated procedure.

immediately and other early actions are likely to give better chances for a good start of UNDP crisis response.

The **HQ Crisis Management Team (CMT)** was established at the third CB meeting at the beginning of April. The SOPs, however, indicate it's a decision for the first CB meeting. Although every crisis is different and SOPs and guidelines will have to confront the existing reality, to the extent possible the organization should respect indications. Appointment of the CMT, like the appointment of the communication focal points, could be included as standing points in the agenda of the first CB meeting.

An earlier appointment of the CMT could have facilitated better internal communication, which has been reported sometimes as excessive. Several Bureaus and Units at central, regional and country level attend the CB; this can multiply interactions that, if not managed, can result in inefficiencies and delays. Informants have different views on the **internal communications** related to the CB: some consider that thanks to the CB there was a common understanding of the response priorities; others reported instead that the excessive number of people involved caused a communications overload. While this is quite common in the first days of a crisis, it should be actively managed. A communication protocol should be encouraged, for example the appointment at the first CB meeting of one communication focal point on all sides – as it is foreseen in the new SOPs.²⁰ In addition to established responsibilities, communication focal points should provide regular updates (daily, biweekly or as frequent as necessary) with key information and decisions, to maintain all relevant personnel informed as necessary. In the case of TC Pam, the Desk officer from the Regional Hub provided more than 15 updates and her contribution has been repeatedly highlighted as very useful.

On the 24th March, the CB requested a **SURGE Plan**²¹ for the next meeting. This complies with the SOPs, which indicate that the SURGE Plan should be developed on the second week after the onset of the crisis.²² On the 24th, however, a SURGE Planning Team was not deployed yet, and the staff that would coordinate the SURGE Plan elaboration was deployed a few days later, arriving in country on March 27th. The deadline requested by the CB *de facto* shortened an already limited timeframe to a mere 4 days. This forced the elaboration of the SURGE Plan without field assessments, with very short versions or even omission of some of its components.²³ The quality of the Plan was affected by the time constraints imposed. The SURGE Plan is a key document that guides UNDP's work in the initial months of the response and recovery; while it can be amended and improved over time, it should be developed with the minimum conditions to guarantee its quality.

In the new configuration after corporate restructuring, **support to COs** is based mostly in the Regional Hubs (COSQAD, RPPS, MMS), which should contribute to coherence and coordination as all Units/Divisions report to the Deputy Regional Director. Technical support is also available in HQ, via the Bureau for Policy and Programme Support (BPPS). To facilitate coherence and coordination, it would be useful to identify the lead focal points (both at RH and HQ) on specific areas of work, like Local Governance, Livelihoods/Jobs/Economic Recovery, Assessments including PDNAs/PCNAs Interagency ER Coordination, as well as on communications, operations, CRPs, resource mobilization and others.

²⁰ Para 4.2.1 of the new SOPs, version 1.0.

²¹ The SURGE Plan is discussed in Chapter 2.2.2.1

²² Para. 126 and following of the 2012 SOPs.

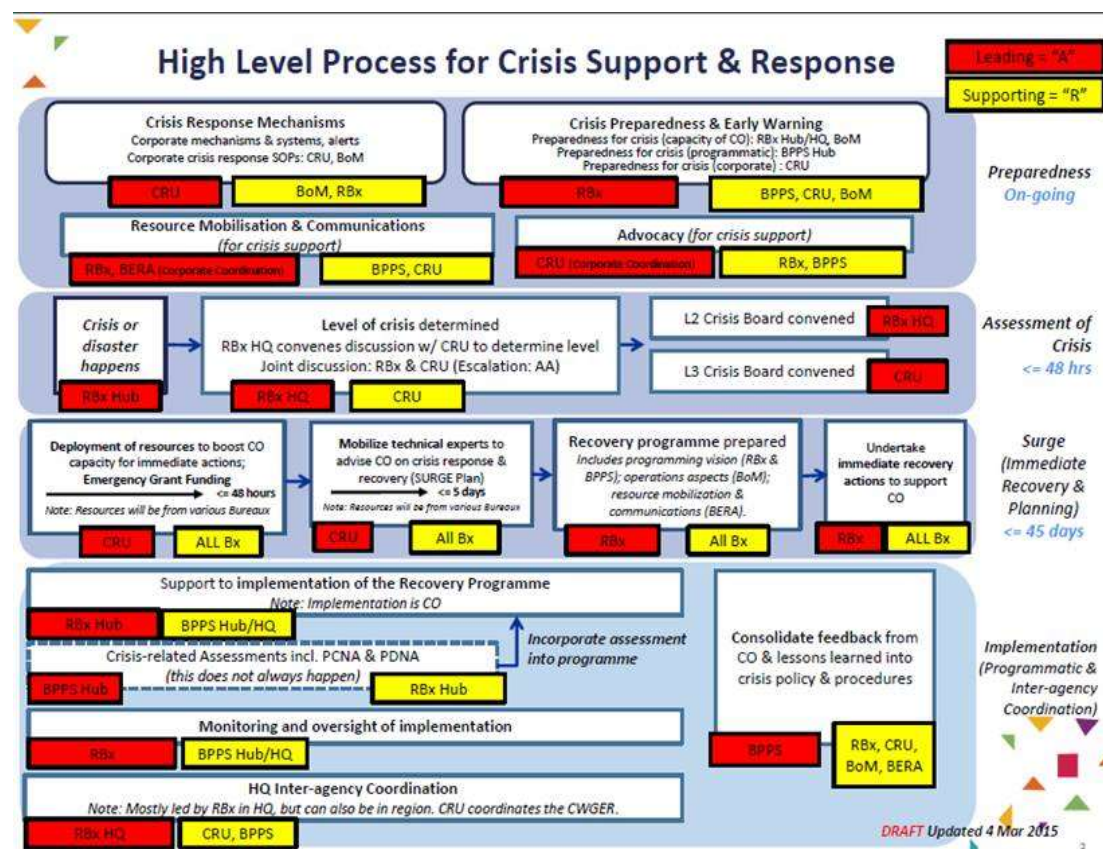
²³ According to the SOPs, these are the CO's 18-24 months programmatic vision (UNDP Early Recovery Plan), the CO's 18-24 months operational vision (Revised CO and Field Structure) and the three-month SURGE Work Plan, to be approved by the CB.

At the same time, only essential focal points should participate in CB and CMT meetings, to avoid an excessive growth of these mechanisms that could hamper their rapid functioning and decision-making. It is also important to clarify the respective roles of BPPS, RH/RPPS, CRU and the Desk Officers in country support, to avoid duplications and to make stronger use of the resources available within the organization.

At the time of the cyclone UNDP was in full transition from the previous configuration (BCPR) to the current one (BPPS/CRU/Regional Hubs), likely affecting the performance of the organization: staff were transitioning from HQ to regions, there were multiple reporting lines that made less clear who would be responsible for deciding deployments, it was not established who would financially support them. This has probably increased the lead-time in finding suitable staff as first responders to TC Pam operation. The 2012 SOPs state that in an L2 crisis it is a CB responsibility to mobilize response from relevant HQ Units (but they do not mention RB Units); the new accountability framework instead gives overall responsibility to CRU and direct responsibility to RHs.

The Table 1 in the next page shows how the **mobilization of technical experts** is led by CRU and supported by Regional Bureaus. At the same time, technical advisors and specialists in the Regional Bureau do not report to CRU: they report to RBAP Deputy Director and liaise with BPPS in HQ. In this configuration, CRU has the responsibility to lead the mobilization of technical experts but not the authority to deploy regional staff as first responders.

Table 1: High Level Process for Crisis Support and Response



At the time of TC Pam, there were no established mechanisms to address this divergence and how to manage equally important but conflicting priorities of different nature. This resulted in a delay in finding suitable staff to deploy as first responders.

All potential **first responders** from the Regional Hub were on mission to attend the Sendai Conference and were not immediately available to deploy. In addition, some informants mentioned potential first responders who simply declared themselves unavailable; CRU had to contact several roster members before finding someone willing to deploy. The first deployee arrived in Fiji on the 19th of March, 6 days after the disaster. As delays in the very first days of a crisis response can have significant consequences for the entire operation, it is necessary for the organization to have a mechanism in place to avoid them.

Participation in UNDP First Responders Roster is voluntary, and it can be affected by previous engagements, simultaneous commitments and other reasons. At the same time, emergency needs are rightly pressing. It is important for UNDP to find the right formula for the application of the First Responders Business Practice. Possible solutions include incentives to staff to be included in the First Responders Roster (for example on performance evaluation, or opportunities for professional development) and incentives for staff and managers to ensure rapid deployment. In addition, the organization should consider what measures are necessary to fulfill staff responsibilities in the office of provenance, when they are deployed on assignment (for example, funding a temporary replacement or providing temporary support from the Regional Hubs or neighbouring COs). These measures can increase the willingness of staff to be part of the FR Roster and of different offices to nominate staff for detail assignments, in addition to those who are automatically considered first responders.

3.2.3.2 Deployments

This section addresses the three types of deployments received by the MCO: UNDP First Responders, SURGE Advisors, and personnel from the Swedish Civil Contingencies Agency (MSB) as UNDP Stand-by Partner. The table below shows deployment dates and destinations (more details are included in Annex 6.5).

Table 2: Deployments to Fiji MCO

Date	Vanuatu	Tuvalu
13 March	<i>Tropical Cyclone Pam</i>	
19 March	Zubair Murshed (Amman)	MacDonald Kadzatsa (Fiji MCO)
22 March	Moortaza Jiwanji (Pacific Centre)	
23 March	Tim Walsh, MSB	
27 March	Silke von Brockhausen (BERA) Karen Bernard (Eq.Guinea CO) Asmaa Shalabi (CRU)	
1 April	Marc-Antoine Morel, consultant	
12 April	Ana Fonseca, MSB	
Mid April	Sanny Jegillos (RBAP) Francisco Santos-Jara Padrón (RBAP-BRH)	Camille Laude, MSB
27 April		Maria Garcia (Colombia CO)
15 May	Faisal Ridwan, MSB	

First responders and SURGE Plan

By the time of the second CB meeting, the MCO had compiled a list of human resources needed:

- Vanuatu: Senior Recovery Advisor for 3 months;
- Tuvalu: Senior Recovery Advisor who knows UNDP and can also handle UN coordination for potential Flash Appeal for 3 months;
- Vanuatu and Suva: Programme Specialist to prepare and implement Flash Appeal project on recovery (UN Joint Programme);
- Vanuatu: UNDP Head of Office to also cover representation, donor relations, inter-agency and help establish UNDP office for 3 -6 months, to be converted into regular post funded from recovery projects in the future;
- Tuvalu: Debris Management Specialist (3-4 weeks) (can be consultant or from roster)
- Suva: Detailed assignment to support MCO programmes in the other 8 countries.

The first person available to deploy was an Advisor from Amman Regional Hub who arrived on the 19th March (6 days after the cyclone) for 2 weeks. The other first responders²⁴ arrived between the 23rd and 27th March for periods of 4 to 6 weeks from different HQ units (CRU and BERA in particular) and from Equatorial Guinea CO:

- A DRR/Recovery Advisor, for 2 weeks;
- A Recovery Advisor, for 3 months (Tuvalu);
- A Programme Coordinator, for 1 week;
- A Debris Management expert, for 4 weeks via MSB;
- A DRR/Recovery Advisor, for 4 weeks;
- A Communications Specialist, for 6 weeks;
- A Programme Specialist, for 2.5 weeks.

Two of the requests from the MCO, however, were not addressed: the UNDP Head of Office and the detail assignment to support MCO in remaining countries. As we will see in Chapter 3.3, this had important consequences on representation and resource mobilization.

All first responders were experienced staff or consultants, already exposed to SURGE or emergency deployments and with UNDP experience, including the first MSB deployment. Despite the delays, the deployment of the **first responders** was very much appreciated by the MCO and their quality recognized; they provided UNDP with much needed capacity, almost absent in Vanuatu that had only one NOB posted in the Joint UN Office. First deployments and the most senior positions are better served by experienced UNDP staff that already know the organization and its functioning. External surge and consultants should be assigned on technical aspects of the response.

Staff deployed from HQ and RB/RH already knew each other, and had worked together previously which contributed to good **communication and coordination**. There was also good

²⁴ Although not discussed in this chapter, for completeness we will indicate that SURGE Advisors, in addition to the first responders, then included:

- A Senior Recovery Advisor, initially planned for 1 month
- An Early Recovery/Recovery Advisor, whose ToRs changed during the 3.5 months of his deployment
- A Coordination Specialist, deployed in Tuvalu
- Three additional MSB deployments (one in Tuvalu)

collaboration between MCO staff and incoming deployees, although some informants report that because of the number of new staff and the high turnover, coordination and communication sometimes became a challenge. Phasing of deployments is frequently difficult, and more so if the CO has limited absorption capacity.

In 2015, UNDP had a unit called the **Pacific Centre**, whose chief was very active and engaged from the outset of the response. The Centre had personnel and projects, resources that could have been used in the first days, when there was not a strong presence in Vanuatu and until the rest of the team deployed. However, because of tensions between project staff and local authorities, this could have also been counterproductive. In the end, it was decided not to use the resources of the Pacific Centre.²⁵

The **remoteness** of the area also affected arrivals. First Responders should be deployed, to the extent possible, from the same region – not only because of the proximity but also because regional experts are likely to know better regional issues and forces at play, resources and opportunities. Since this is not always possible, the organisation then turns to its global resources, to ensure that the best capacities are deployed.

The delay in the first deployments, paired with limited capacity in country, affected UNDP response potential in the first days of the emergency, for example it affected its participation in the initial **assessments**, which in turn affected the quality of the documents elaborated (like the SURGE Plan and the CERF proposals, not based on assessments).

There was an initial uncertainty and repeated changes from the MCO in the support requested, and on which human resources to include in the SURGE Plan. Previous reflections on the most relevant response profiles, as part of preparedness, could avoid this difficulty. The MCO was not always responsive on the **ToRs** of the first responders and some deployed with only draft ToRs; although their role became clearer later on, with the evolution of the situation on the ground, a clear endorsement of ToRs by management is advisable. SURGE staff also saw their ToRs change during their deployments; this is a very common occurrence in emergencies: initial decisions or estimations are often made with limited information and change over time. It is normal and should be accepted as such; however, after some time deployees and management should discuss if the initial ToRs are still relevant or if they should be updated, and changes should be communicated to all staff. This is most relevant for a MCO, because of the distance between decision-making in Suva and implementation in Port Vila.

The **SURGE Plan**, part of the First Responders responsibility, should include:

- UNDP Initial Recovery Plan (18-24 months), to be developed as a pre-requisite of the SURGE Work Plan and included as annex. This initial plan has 5 components:
 - The Recovery Results and Resource Framework
 - The Resource Mobilization Plan
 - The Communications and Advocacy Plan
 - The Staff Safety and Security Plan
 - The Cost Recovery Strategy
- Revised CO and Field Structure, to be developed as a pre-requisite of the SURGE Work Plan and included as annex
- SURGE Work Plan, which includes the SURGE Project Brief and the SURGE Budget.

²⁵ The Pacific Centre has been now merged with the MCO to form the Pacific Office, covering 15 countries with its national and regional projects.

TC Pam SURGE Plan included only short versions of its principal components, and not all the required elements, mainly because of the brief time allowed for its elaboration.

The SURGE Plan guides UNDP's work in the first months of the response and recovery; in other crises responses, similar documents have been fundamental tools for the success of UNDP's operations. One example is the Framework Programme developed by Bosnia Herzegovina CO during the response to floods in 2014. This is a flexible and well-structured tool for programme design and resource mobilization, useful both for the emergency phase and for the recovery phase. It is an overarching document that frames UNDP's response, recovery and resilience strategy and plans and provides coherence to its resource mobilization efforts.²⁶

At the time of writing, a compact version of the SURGE Plan is under discussion for inclusion in the new SOPs, featuring its main components and required only when a focal point or a small team is deployed (and not the full SURGE Planning Team). This option gives an additional choice to the organization depending on the level of the crisis, and balances the need for adequate planning with the need for speed both in planning and implementation.

SURGE Advisors and staff for SURGE Plan

During the SURGE phase were deployed as **SURGE Advisors**²⁷:

- A Senior Recovery Advisor, initially planned for 1 month but in fact deployed for less time and with missions in between;
- An Early Recovery/Recovery Advisor, initially planned for 1 month, then extended on two occasions to a total of around 3.5 months;
- A UN Coordination Specialist, deployed in Tuvalu for 3 months.

Several informants have highlighted the contribution of **local staff**, who assisted the technical experts and SURGE Advisors not only in communicating with people but who also advised them on the local context and how to adapt 'signature' solutions to the reality of the country.

The **SURGE Plan** identified as priority positions:

- | |
|---|
| 1. Debris Management Advisor - Port Vila (P4) |
| 2. Recovery Project Manager - Port Vila (P4) |
| 3. Debris Management & Recovery Advisor - Tuvalu (P4) |
| 4. NOA Procurement Analyst |
| 5. ER Cluster Coordinator and Advisor (P5, 1 month) |
| 6. Recovery Advisor – Port Vila (P4) |

²⁶ A few weeks after the floods in Bosnia and Herzegovina in May 2014, UNDP CO designed a Framework Programme. It included response activities, showing the continuity and coherence of the approach, aimed at linking response and recovery. It highlighted UNDP's vision and strategy, including response, recovery and resilience, and encompassing all detected needs –but it did not develop separate funding proposals in advance. Once donors were interested either in providing non-earmarked assistance, or in funding a particular segment of the programme, the two parties agreed and UNDP developed short project proposals. The Framework programme is discussed in the "After Action Review on Bosnia Herzegovina 2014 floods".

²⁷ In addition to the First Responders already mentioned and based on the support requested by the MCO and the SURGE Plan.

The **Debris Management positions in Vanuatu and Tuvalu** were covered by MSB deployments.²⁸

The **Recovery Project Manager** was a consultant, employed for six months. Initially recruited as the Recovery Coordinator, his role evolved to responsibilities similar to a Country Programme Advisor, but this was not reflected in updated ToRs. The evolution from a technical and response-centered role to a more strategic one shows that the need for leadership and strategic positioning of the organization emerged in Vanuatu. This was somehow addressed but no one was formally appointed as Head of Office.

The **Early Recovery Advisor / Cluster Coordinator** position was initially covered by the RBAP Senior Recovery Advisor. This deployment was fragmented: it started approximately a month after the cyclone, then after a few days the staff traveled to another country, returned to Vanuatu, then deployed to Nepal because of the earthquake. The MCO was aware of previous commitments; however, the lack of continuity at a critical time reportedly affected relationships with Government officers. Continuity in the support provided is often underestimated in emergencies, but it is essential. In post-disaster contexts, with a sudden increase in organizations and staff, Governments will favour consistency in the support they receive; at senior level it is very important to pay attention to relationship management with the Government, especially if UNDP takes an advisory role in the response or in the transition to recovery and reconstruction.

Because of the nature of this position (Early Recovery Advisor), the deployment should have been among the first ones and in the initial days of the crisis response. The ERA arrived instead in mid-April. Lack of knowledge and understanding was reported among Government and partners about Early Recovery, its implications and importance from the very beginning of the humanitarian response. ER discussions should take place immediately when the strategic lines of the response are discussed between government and partners. In these moments, the presence of a skilled ER Advisor with the ability to influence decision-makers, is crucial.

There was no Early Recovery Cluster in TC Pam response; ER activities were included in other cluster's work plans like Education and Agriculture/Livelihoods. There were some cluster-like activities: coordination of all ER-related inputs, mapping of ER interventions implemented by NGOs or UN Agencies, a list of priority ER interventions. The ER projects in the Flash Appeal were not funded. While this happened for multiple causes, it is reasonable to think that the lack of a strong ER voice at the beginning of the response has not favoured resource mobilization, coordination and the programmatic side of UNDP response, and therefore UNDP's position vis-à-vis authorities and partners.

Ultimately, the deployment ended in April, as UNDP's offer of strategic support on recovery remained pending with the Prime Minister's Office (PMO). Some of the functions of the ER Advisor were later assumed by the Recovery Advisor (also deployed as SURGE from the Regional Hub).

The ER Advisory function is very important immediately after the disaster, particularly in countries like Vanuatu where the Government might not be very knowledgeable about early recovery and therefore does not automatically consider it in its plans. In fact, many informants reported a general perception of insufficient dedicated technical guidance on ER.

²⁸ See chapter on Stand-by Partners.

The continued presence and expertise of an ER/Recovery Advisor, including beyond the SURGE phase, could have helped position UNDP not only for immediate response, but also for longer-term recovery. A CO might not be initially engaged with the Government national recovery efforts, and focus instead on immediate response activities, like CfW and debris management. It is important, though, that they do not become “ends in themselves” but remain entry points for longer-term recovery engagement.

When planning crisis response and ER/Recovery phases, the CO shall reflect well on the strategic results the ER and Recovery functions should achieve, if pertinent linking the ToRs and deployments of the ER and Recovery Advisors.

ER and Recovery support would benefit from staff continuity, with at least one person remaining throughout the transition. While continuity is ensured by the MCO and by UNDP as an organization, individual continuity would be a better option. Form should follow function: at least one SURGE Advisor should remain long enough to accompany the transition to recovery phase. Continuity should also be supported through deployments overlap of a few days to allow for direct handover.

The **Procurement Analyst** position was not covered, because of lack of funds.

Finally, the **Recovery Advisor** position was covered through a RH SURGE for about 3.5 months. During the deployment, the SURGE Advisor role transformed: the situation was changing a lot and Government priorities evolved, naturally affecting UNDP response; the Advisor worked on the recovery planning process, and was involved in coordination, supported by an OCHA consultant. This support facilitated his role as Recovery Advisor, who advocates for UNDP on ER and recovery, but who has also a broader responsibility in supporting and advocating on Early Recovery for all stakeholders.

As the disaster was relatively small, it was possible for one person to assume multiple roles, while normally it might be necessary to have two different deployments for livelihoods, PDNA and recovery planning. The Recovery Advisor was posted at the Prime Minister’s Office (PMO), he participated in the identification of sectorial Government priorities, contributed to the elaboration of the National Recovery Plan and of the Vanuatu National Sustainable Plan 2016-2030, supporting the PMO in aligning plans to the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs). He also coordinated UNDP inputs to the Humanitarian Action Plan, and continued UNDP work on PDNA.

When considering the support to request, COs with help from RH and HQ should consider the possibility of either having two positions or only one: if the two positions can be merged, then the ToRs should reflect it.

This can be planned in advance. The MCO should consider, in its preparedness plans and knowing the ER and recovery context in each country, what type of support and profile(s) would be more useful. These could be ER Advisors, PDNA Specialists, Livelihoods Advisors or others, or some position that covers multiple roles. The MCO can think strategically what results these profiles should achieve and develop ToRs accordingly. HQ and the RH can provide technical guidance and support on possible strategic results and required profiles; these considerations can also be part of the corporate preparedness and capacity building, particularly for CO senior managers (for example through scenario-based exercises).

The deployment of a **UN Coordination Specialist** took a long time, which contributed to a perceived lack of UN coordination at programmatic level and also on early recovery, particularly at the beginning of the response.

As a final note, several informants highlighted the importance of selecting staff or consultants for deployments not only for their technical expertise but also with the adequate **soft skills** (like negotiation and communication), especially for a difficult political environment like in Vanuatu. This is important if they will have to represent the CO at senior level; such skills can help them accessing strategic niches for engagement that otherwise might not become available.

Stand-by Partner (MSB)

The Swedish Civil Contingencies Agency (MSB) is one of UNDP Stand-By Partners; they contributed 4 people, 3 to Vanuatu and 1 to Tuvalu for variable periods between 4 weeks and 3 months, as Debris Management specialists.²⁹

There is widespread consensus on the high quality and skills of the personnel deployed. Their skills went from former UNDP experience, knowledge of the system and ability to represent UNDP in coordination or resource mobilization meetings; to the ability to organize work quickly and efficiently, using limited resources. This guaranteed good reputational outcomes for UNDP. Other positive elements were the capacity to listen to local populations and stakeholders and to adapt the programme approach to the local reality and needs.

Deployments were short, and even if MSB personnel overlapped for a few days and could conduct handovers, in general turnover is detrimental: it slows down the response; relations with authorities and communities need to be established again, and every new deployee needs a few days to be completely operational in a new environment. Longer deployments - at least up to three months - would be preferable, and the same MSB seems to prefer them, encouraging UNDP to make 6 months deployment requests that can be shortened as necessary.

One respondent informed that there are often long negotiations between UNDP and MSB at HQ level, which delay deployments. The first MSB deployee arrived in country 10 days after the disaster, which is late for a pressing concern like debris clearance, necessary to ensure access for the rest of the assistance and relief. An earlier deployment both by UNDP and MSB would have enabled more effective early interventions, the participation in the initial assessments, and a greater opportunity to secure contributions from donors. Support from the CRU Programme Specialist helped in advancing the deployment of the second round of MSB staff.

MSB specialists are technical specialists and do not always have UN experience. They might not have the exposure or knowledge of the system required to represent UNDP in inter-agency meetings, in meetings with the Government or where resource allocation is discussed; also, they might not have sufficient access to Government officers, especially at the higher levels. For these reasons, MSB staff is better deployed in support to a UNDP Debris Management Advisor, to help on project management functions while UNDP Advisors work on programme issues within UNDP and at clusters and interagency level.

²⁹ Annex II presents details of all deployments.

3.2.4. UNDP MCO

Before TC Pam, UNDP's presence in Vanuatu was limited to a national officer in the Joint UN Office. A **special desk** was established to support TC Pam response, Operations staff rotated between Fiji and Vanuatu; in addition, one Operations Manager was deployed to Vanuatu. There is ample consensus about his excellent performance, flexibility, capacity to respect the rules and maintain the required control and accountabilities, and at the same time find creative solutions to address programmatic needs. Enabling factors were the knowledge of internal rules and regulation, exposure to previous emergencies and the right "can do" attitude and flexibility. This local staff has been recommended for SURGE deployments. UNDP should support the development of local staff, by identifying capable local staff in countries prone to emergencies, training them on crisis response rules and regulations and providing them with the right knowledge and experience, through secondments or missions, to be 'assets' in crisis response.

The rapid scale-up and programme expansion led to the **establishment of a UNDP Office**, however **no Head of Office** was formally appointed. This need was addressed with temporary solutions that did not solve key issues of representation and resource mobilization generated. The problem originates in the multi-country nature of the office, and the MCO considers it a standing challenge.

The unfulfilled need for formal leadership, at the appropriate level of seniority, remained throughout the response. Neither the MCO, nor RH and HQ recognized at the time the need to take a stronger action, but there were important consequences. The lack of a representative with sufficient seniority and formal appointment – besides the RR/RC/HC who, as mentioned before, had a *super partes* role – meant that in resource mobilization meetings there was not a strong enough voice to advocate for UNDP position. When CERF proposals were discussed, presence was not sufficient and UNDP could not include its activities in CERF, therefore it did not receive any CERF funds.³⁰ On several occasions, consultants or stand-by partners were expected to represent UNDP in clusters and at Government level, without the representational capacity and the decision-making authority that would have been necessary in these circumstances.

The lack of a Head of Office on the ground to whom all would have reported caused also some challenges in communication and coordination, because of the multiple reporting lines, a division of roles and responsibilities that was sometimes unclear or not well communicated among local/locally recruited staff and "external" experts. Sometimes this led to tensions within the office and to contradictory messages going out to external partners, to the detriment of UNDP's consistency and to some extent of its relationship with the Government.

An important factor in successful response is the **knowledge of corporate procedures**, guidelines, support options from HQ and Regional Hubs. For example, the presence of a CRU first responder, expert on procedures and opportunities for assistance, sped up and facilitated several processes. If already informed and trained, decision makers (ex. RC/HC or Country Directors) can make better use of the different types of support available.

Given the increasing vulnerability of countries to disaster, the growing frequency and severity of crises, UNDP should train all its RRs/RCs, Deputy RRs and Country Directors on the corporate approach and mechanisms for crisis response, early recovery and recovery. It should orient them on recovery coordination and global processes that unfold after disasters

³⁰ A more detailed discussion on resource mobilization and related challenges is included in Chapter 3.3

(e.g. Flash Appeals, CERF, PDNA). This is even more relevant after the recent restructuring and the future approval of new CSOPs and Crisis Response Packages for disaster response.

The expansion of UNDP programmes should prompt reflection at global, regional and MCO level on its position after the response and recovery phases, as UNDP presence grew and so have expectations on its role, future commitment and presence in country. This is valid for any other CO: with a stronger presence and increased resources come increased expectations from Governments, donors, partners and the population, and they need to be managed. The organization should always consider, at the beginning of its response, a growth strategy or an exit strategy, depending on the potential role of the CO and the resource mobilization opportunities.

The organization should reflect on the investment it is ready to make or to sustain, for countries like Vanuatu which may be less strategic due to isolation, capacity, visibility or other reasons, but which are vulnerable to disasters, especially climate-related ones. To be well positioned to respond to possible future crises and their development challenges, UNDP needs to make the appropriate investments on preparedness, increasing its capacity and structure in the most vulnerable countries.

The MCO did not have a **preparedness plan**. It has a Business Continuity Plan, which includes provisions for the critical roles in the office, and its programmes include risk-assessments, to counter possible consequences of disaster on programmes.

Given the high vulnerability of the region to cyclones and weather-related events, and their increasing frequency and severity, the experience with TC Pam and currently with TC Winston, the MCO (now Pacific Office) must develop a comprehensive preparedness plan.

Recommended components of the plan include:

- Likely scenarios, such as disasters in one or more countries, and the different implications if the disaster is in Fiji or elsewhere.
- Plans for multi-country / management level when a disaster strikes in one or more countries other than Fiji, and complementary brief individual response plans for each country.
- A deployment plan of MCO staff to address the scenarios identified, with priority given to a Head of Office and a coordination officer. MCO staff are much better placed than surge staff or consultants to represent UNDP, as they know the country programme, the local context and partners. To avoid the lack of senior representation experienced in TC Pam, the MCO could determine the mechanism by which, in case of crisis, someone is appointed as temporary CD or Head of Office and is in charge of UNDP representation. This could be the Deputy RR, delegating his/her responsibilities towards the other countries to Assistant Representatives; one of the Assistant Representatives; another senior MCO staff; multiple options are possible, but they should be identified and agreed *before* a crisis happens.
- Similarly to the corporate mechanism, a list of MCO “first responders” for immediate deployment and a second wave of staff, able to remain deployed for a longer time (at least 3-6 months). A better integration and exchanges between the programme team in Fiji and staff based in the other countries can be fostered in non-disaster times, to strengthen familiarity with local conditions, authorities and partners, and facilitate immediate deployment for response and recovery.
- Surge support and profiles likely required (depending on the scenarios identified) and ToRs of potential surge;

- A joint plan with other UN agencies for representation in case of disaster where there is a Joint UN Presence
- Identification of preparedness and immediate response needs in programmatic terms, including the kick start of crisis response packages, and for Operations (including remote support and business continuity);
- Cost/benefit analysis of supplies prepositioning for UNDP crisis response packages (such as debris management and CfW). Experts report that prepositioned supplies and equipment would have allowed for a response in 2 weeks instead than 4 weeks, effectively halving the response time;
- Identification and if possible stand-by agreements with partners for crisis response (for example with local NGOs or local companies for debris management and livelihood activities, with local banks or mobile providers for CfW and other similar options, adapted to the local cultural and political context); pre-established agreements would also strongly reduce lead-times to initiate the response, as they would have to be only activated and not negotiated;
- Long Term Agreements with local suppliers, for materials and equipment sourced in local markets (as a complement or an alternative to pre-positioning);
- Training for staff and if pertinent for partners on crisis management, humanitarian programming cycle and early recovery. This should be based on assessed capacity needs, and differentiated according to the roles that staff would play in the response. For example, training for senior management would focus on strategic issues, and on the corporate tools available for response and recovery, while training for programme staff could focus on the Crisis Response Packages.

A useful approach that is not strictly preparedness but conduces to similar results consists in better **positioning the organization through programming**. Considering potential response activities, the CO can structure regular programmatic interventions as potential entry points for crisis response. It can also map existing programmes with the same aim.

UNDP should engage with the humanitarian community in country (for example the Pacific Humanitarian Team, or the Vanuatu Humanitarian Team and other country-specific mechanisms), to position itself as a response and recovery actor; to raise awareness on Early Recovery and on its implications in humanitarian response and for recovery. Such constructive engagement is better pursued during non-disaster times, with Governments, partners, donors, so that when a disaster happens UNDP has already opened a channel of communication and possibly collaboration with them. It can be done for example in the frame of its preparedness programmes, as a capacity building component of this programme, or an awareness raising / communication campaign.

3.3. Resource mobilization

The first CB meeting recalled the importance of resource mobilization and the lesson from Philippines “Not to miss out on resource mobilization, because once the first window of opportunity closes, there will be no second round”. This lesson was not well learned, at least in the case of TC Pam.

The MCO requested and received USD 50,000 from RBAP for immediate action (to establish the basis for the operation in Vanuatu), then USD 350,000 from TRAC 3, and an allocation of USD 476,000 to fund a Project Initiation Plan (PIP) for Vanuatu. The office reports that the presence of a CRU Specialist among first responders helped a lot with the **immediate internal**

resource mobilization, as she was aware of funding opportunities, and could provide a direct line to HQ decision makers. BPPS technical assistance to the MCO on proposal development was also critical for the allocation of the Vanuatu PIP.

In addition to internal mobilization, COs also have the option of reallocating funds, if this is agreed with donors. Reportedly, attempts at repurposing some GEF resources of the Vanuatu project were made, but they were not successful.

During the initial weeks, a PIP for Tuvalu for USD 300,000 was also discussed several times in CB meetings, after the approval of the Vanuatu PIP. The MCO with technical assistance from BPPS prepared a proposal, but in the end this was not funded for lack of resources at central level. This demonstrates that the mechanism for internal allocation of immediate resources did not function well on this occasion – as funds were allocated for one country (Vanuatu) but not for another (Tuvalu) affected by the same disaster – and staff time was employed to design a proposal that ultimately failed. However, the Tuvalu proposal remained valid for external resource mobilization efforts.

The organization was not able to mobilize **funds from humanitarian sources** and it missed direct opportunities with bilateral donors like Japan. As reported, Japan required a proposal in 2/3 days, while the CO was given around 1 week – because of some miscommunication, not further specified. By the time the proposal was ready, funds had already been earmarked for UNICEF.

UNDP intended to apply for CERF funds, like other agencies; its projects, however, were not accepted for final submission as not in line with “life-saving criteria”. When funding was discussed with OCHA and other HCT members, UNDP did not have an authoritative representative with sufficient seniority, different³¹ from the RR/RC/HC; this reduced its voice and gravitas in discussions, ultimately contributing to the failure of its efforts.

The experience of the organization has been different on different occasions; in some cases, debris management was not accepted as “life-saving”, in others it was. Every situation is unique and there are multiple reasons for such different outcomes; nevertheless, UNDP should make all possible efforts at country level for a successful submission and globally for the recognition of some of its activities as life-saving.

At country level, it is important to ensure that the content, language, and the way activities are presented, are adequate for CERF and successfully build the case for funding; ideally, people drafting CERF proposals should have experience and know how to observe the criteria required. UNDP is now developing Crisis Response Packages that will include templates and samples for the most common funding mechanisms, including CERF. At global level, negotiations on the famous “life-saving criteria” (for example including debris management) could be very useful for country submissions, as they would render void the immediate objections the MCO has received in this case.

³¹ Informants have mixed views on the RR/RC/HC responsibilities to secure funding for UNDP; the IASC ToRs for Humanitarian Coordinators, however, state that “s/he is responsible for leading and coordinating humanitarian action of relevant organisations in country with a view to ensuring that it is principled, timely, effective and efficient, and contributes to longer-term recovery. [...] The HC represents the Emergency Relief Coordinator (ERC) in country.” Therefore, when the RR also becomes HC, s/he does not represent UNDP in the context of the humanitarian coordination and response, another UNDP representative should participate in meeting in representation of UNDP as individual agency. See IASC, Terms of Reference for the Humanitarian Coordinator. <https://www.humanitarianresponse.info/system/files/documents/files/IASC%20Terms%20of%20Reference%20for%20Humanitarian%20Coordinators.pdf>

Ultimately, the fundraising through the Flash Appeal was completely unsuccessful: the initial budget for early recovery was USD 2.3 million, of which USD 1.9 million for UNDP, later revised to 700,000; no funds were received.

The limited resources UNDP had for initial activities probably affected further funding opportunities: the organization had fewer operations, less visibility and a weaker position in the response.

Resource mobilization for recovery focused on a Joint Programme with other UN agencies (ILO, UN Habitat, UN Women, UNV); DFAT was interested in livelihoods restoration and community infrastructure rehabilitation, and it had previously indicated a strong preference for UN agencies working together.

Some UN agencies then decided to develop a Joint programme, building upon existing partnerships (such as the UN Women “Markets for Change” programme, funded by DFAT and of which UNDP was an implementing partner). UNDP started the design of the JP immediately with first responders; the design was quite complex as some of the agencies did not even have presence on the ground, and ended up without a strong cohesive approach, it took a long time to develop and it was finally submitted as part of the recovery plan of the government.

DFAT decided to fund only UN Women; UNDP conducted intense lobbying but without result and ended up financing its part of the Programme through the PIP funds (USD 476,000). Some informants have questioned the opportunity of a Joint Programme as the best tool for an emergency context, given the complexities of its design, coordination and implementation arrangements. The resources spent on designing the JP could have been spent instead on UNDP own projects and activities, with possible better results and visibility for the organization. Albeit speculative, this observation has its merits: during the first critical months there are limited resources in terms of time, energy and staff, it is important to evaluate the cost-opportunity of how these resources are invested. For this reasons, frequent reviews of the strategy are recommended, as well as a review of the ToRs of the staff and surge deployed, to adapt quickly re response of the office to an often rapidly evolving situation.

The JP was prioritized as a potential funding opportunity, it was initiated at the very beginning of the response but as it evolved, it took a long time to develop for the reasons already stated. The nature of emergency response is not particularly conducive to evaluation, and a deliberate effort must be made to assess, in real-time, what the organization is doing and why. The reasons that led to an initiative in the first days of the response might be no longer valid, the situation might have evolved in a way that requires adjustments or a change of direction. Some organisations conduct real-time evaluations with this purpose, if UNDP is not able to conduct a formal RTE, it should at least plan, one month, one month and a half in the response, an occasion to stop response/ER, assess progress, potential pitfalls, current difficulties. This should be done beyond the regular internal coordination meetings, as a separate event (for example half a day) to allow for proper reflection, and with the participation of the RH and HQ. This should also be repeated regularly, every three months at least.

Later on the MCO received around USD 500,000 from Russia (with support from BERA and RBEC) and another USD 500,000 on SDGs from the Spanish Trust Fund for activities on livelihoods and economic empowerment that are considered a continuation of the initial recovery work.

The reasons for UNDP's failure in mobilizing external resources for response and recovery are manifold: some are contextual, some are related to the humanitarian system and some are related to UNDP's action (or lack thereof) and can be addressed.

External or contextual factors include the following:

- The donor pool in the Pacific is narrow (although not inexistent), and this in itself limits the possibilities available.
- The GoV requested that all donor funding be channeled through Government structures and did not advocate for assistance and advisory support from the United Nations and other multilateral organizations. This – coupled with political instability, lack of leadership, frequent accusations of corruption – induced donors to caution, refraining from major investments in the response and recovery, which in turn limited UNDP's opportunities for resource mobilization. The Recovery Committee in charge of reviewing projects and assigning funds (of the USD 45 million received) did not approve any proposal; at the time of the interviews it was not known exactly how much it has been spent.
- Some contextual circumstances have also contributed negatively: the region has a small population, is distant and isolated; this can make the emergency less “interesting” and resource mobilization more difficult. In the case of TC Pam, the situation worsened when another major disaster, the Nepal earthquake, happened only a few weeks afterwards, diverting many resources from other crises.
- UNDP's role in the humanitarian system and how this is perceived at local level are also important. The debate is not new and is not limited to Vanuatu; historically UNDP has been a development organisation with reduced involvement in humanitarian activities; in the last years, however, the organization has shown a strong involvement in crisis response in major emergencies (for example in Haiti, Pakistan, oPt, Lebanon, Sudan, Somalia). UNDP is sometimes seen by others either as a newcomer in the humanitarian arena or as not having a role in the immediate response (and therefore not requiring funds); its activities might not be considered life-saving and the importance of early recovery might not be appreciated to the extent it deserves.

In addition to these ‘external’ factors, the organization should also recognize some **internal reasons** that have contributed:

- The absence of a senior Head of Office in Vanuatu with the required authority and gravitas to represent the organization and advocate for resources in the negotiation with other HCT members.
- UNDP's limited presence during initial assessments, a combination of the previous limited presence in Vanuatu, and the delays in the first deployments. This in turn reduced the visibility of the organization and it might have influenced donors' perceptions on its role in crisis response and its capacity to deliver.
- Limited funds available to the MCO. If it had managed to access more resources, it would have had the opportunity for more activities, more presence and visibility, increasing its positioning and weight vis-à-vis Government and donors.

- Lack of awareness and knowledge on early recovery by the government and partners, particularly at the initial stage; the absence of an ER cluster within the cluster system, the short deployment of the Early Recovery Advisor have all contributed to the impossibility of raising funds for early recovery. In fact, the ER projects in the Flash Appeal have received no funds at all, against an average cluster funding of 58 % of requirements.
- Finally, a reported persistent perception by donors of being considered merely funders. A more consistent engagement with donors before emergencies, and an effort to build partnerships with them rather than a functional relation, might work better on the long term; it will require however a different approach and a sustained engagement, rather than simply presenting proposals. This is valid both at CO level and at HQ.

Given these challenges, UNDP could take several measures, both at country level and at regional/global level.

At MCO level:

- Preparedness and programme design: When designing programmes and projects, take into consideration the likely disaster scenarios and crisis response and recovery needs; reflect on how to align or adapt programme activities so that they could be converted or built-upon in crisis response, early recovery and recovery (for example, a regular programme on waste management – this could be converted to debris management and could be immediately activated) . Discuss this aspect with donors and negotiate the repurposing of part of the resources for immediate response. Also, map existing projects in the country (or in the region) that present potential entry points for crisis management (for example, projects on resilience, climate change, disaster risk reduction) and that could be used as initial platforms in the immediate aftermath of a disaster, while the crisis response is set up
- Early engagement and awareness raising with Governments, donors and partners on Early Recovery: in non-disaster times, establish a dialogue with stakeholders on early recovery, position UNDP as a key actor within the country-based and the regional Humanitarian Teams. Also, consider that RM happens in the first weeks but it should not be only about immediate crisis response; open a dialogue on the linkages with long-term recovery and how to connect RM for the two phases.
- Strengthening credibility as a response actor: Consolidate the image and work of UNDP on the ground, develop a solid conceptual and operational approach in crisis response, document it and share it, demonstrate to Governments, partners and donors that the organization can deliver, to increase how UNDP is perceived as a solid and reliable partner.
- Immediate deployment of the right staff: ensure there is always a Head of Office, and consider the needs for Coordination and Resource Mobilization immediate surge.

At RH /HQ level:

- Support the country offices with a RM Advisor (either deployed or remotely) or a RM strategy; in view of the Hayaan lessons on resource mobilization, a “Resource Mobilization Adviser” would have been an important support for the CO. This position, however, was not requested and it was not offered;
- Provide guidance and resources on RM. In the immediate aftermath of a disaster, a CO is very busy with the response and has many competing priorities to address; RM and proposal writing should be made as easy as possible. HQ and RHs can provide

support through templates, standard proposal examples for the most common funding sources (i.e. CERF, bilateral donors). The new Crisis Response Packages address this concern with RM tools like the ones mentioned;

- Provide customized guidance to COs on how to transmit the importance of early recovery activities as life-saving, essential in the immediate response, or directly contributing to life-saving activities (for example, rubble removal);
- Improve the existing mechanism to allocate resources immediately for crisis response (which gives a first opportunity to respond and then to build on that); consider a no-regrets approach for immediate release of funds;
- Engage with donors before a crisis hits, show UNDP's potential with sufficient resources (particularly on ER) and how this supports the entire response; also, profile donors and consider non-traditional ones: one of the informants mentioned Russia and Kuwait, China, Kazakhstan. Support COs by investigating and providing information on possible non-traditional resources;
- Within the humanitarian system, stress at global and (where necessary) country level UNDP's role in crisis management; refine how the organization's role is presented and represented; discuss humanitarian funding criteria and if pertinent frame UNDP's activities within these criteria.

The experience on resource mobilization in TC Pam encourages a reflection. UNDP made an **investment** of around USD 1 million of its own resources between TRAC and PIP funds, and SURGE deployments; Chapter 3.2 highlights the results obtained with these resources. Despite such undeniable results, from a strictly financial perspective it was not a successful operation as the "seed money" invested by the organization did not materialize in further resources. Although RM is not an end in itself, and the success of an operation is not measured on the amount of funds raised but on the impact for the population, it is also true that fewer funds mean fewer opportunities to support the country and its population in recovering from the disaster. It is not possible to make an "investment plan" as such, deciding how many resources to mobilize upfront with a view of a certain financial return. However, a Return on Investment (ROI) type of analysis could help in identifying which resources (seed funds via TRAC and PIP, deployment of first responders or SURGE advisors, investment in RM directly, others) bring the highest returns and should therefore be strengthened. In addition to the RM outcomes, other variables should be considered such as timing, accountability to affected population, the satisfaction of stakeholders, including local and national governments, and other humanitarian actors.

UNDP is a well-known organization, with the broadest network of COs among UN agencies, strongly engaged in supporting Governments; in the majority of cases it does not really have the possibility of not engaging, as it would entail a high reputational risk. Therefore, UNDP often must intervene, but it has to consider what is the adequate investment and effort to be successful.

The organization needs also to consider if positioning UNDP on early recovery conflicts with positioning it on long-term recovery, and the opportunity-cost of resource mobilization for crisis response and early recovery and if this hinders resource mobilization for longer-term activities like reconstruction. The humanitarian field is already crowded and funds are scarce; recent global reports show that although humanitarian aid has increased in absolute terms, it is insufficient compared to needs and the situation worsens every year. Recovery and reconstruction might be less competitive areas, where UNDP does have a comparative advantage above many other organisations. At the same time, lack of positioning in the early stages can lead to limited opportunities later on in recovery and reconstruction.

These considerations go beyond the individual case of TC Pam response, and should be discussed more broadly; they are offered here as a suggestion for further reflections. A useful tool to inform these reflections is a return on investment analysis on early recovery (deployments, funds, resources allocated to support ER at interagency level), and the actual development of initiatives that embed ER principles and approaches. At the same time, a similar analysis (or a Value for Money analysis) on the deployments could give indications to UNDP on the opportunity of continuing with the present corporate support model.

3.4. Programme

The first CB meeting recommended **reviewing MCO programmes** and reorienting them for response, if possible. Initial attempts to repurpose resources from the GEF programme were not successful, so the MCO focused on developing new activities for the response.

In the initial days, UNDP was not able to conduct **field assessments** for lack of personnel in the affected areas (a difficulty also exacerbated by the distance and transport/logistics issues). It did participate in the PDNA and invested time and resources in it; there were some concerns, highlighted in the CB minutes, about long-standing issues on leadership and collaboration with the World Bank; these however seem to have been solved in-country.

UNDP response focused on “meeting the immediate needs in the affected region while also creating conditions for long-term recovery, resilience to multiple shocks including natural hazards and sustainable development.”³² **Planned activities** in Vanuatu centered on local governance, cash for work, livelihoods restoration and resilience. In Tuvalu the programmatic crisis response was limited to debris and waste management.

The **PIP for Vanuatu** aimed at supporting the “Rapid recovery and clean-up of cyclone-affected communities, with new income source and improved skills and alternative livelihoods, for women in the informal economy in particular.”³³ Outputs included:

- Cash income provided for equal numbers of men and women in two cyclone-affected communities;
- Debris cleared from roads and neighbourhoods, and sorted, classified and properly disposed of;
- Local carpentry workshop established, for recycling of fallen trees to be used for housing repair and to replace lost furniture, and operated by local women and men trained under this initiative.

Cash for Work activities presented some challenges: some informants report an initial resistance from local authorities and counterparts to adopt the CfW approach, despite its success in many emergency contexts. This was due to local cultural practice by which community work is done for free and as a contribution to the community welfare, and it is not compensated financially. However, informants report that direct beneficiaries appreciated CfW interventions: in Vanuatu, it provided immediate cash to people and contributed to the recovery process, as many beneficiaries bought materials to repair their houses. CfW was acceptable in urban areas, but in rural settings, it was a sensitive subject sometimes opposed by local authorities on grounds of increasing dependency (rather than by the population) and not accepted. According to local customs, CfW would have disrupted future community work.

³² United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) Response to Tropical Cyclone Pam, 2 pager (9 April 2015)

³³ Vanuatu Project Initiation Plan (PIP) “Vanuatu Cash-for-Work and Debris Clearance Initiative”, April 2015.

After further consultations, UNDP adapted it – where possible it maintained the usual CfW approach, while in rural areas instead of providing cash it provided community goods or community incentives like tools and worked on community buildings, or it provided individual incentives (like pandanus leaves for weaving). These consultations took a long time and the office considers it a successful result. In fact, this adaptation of a traditional CfW approach to the local context is an interesting case and it could be included as an example in CRPs and other response guidance tools.

UNDP's corporate approach to CfW sees these activities as linked to the recovery process, not as one-off activities or discrete interventions. Rather, they can be entry points for recovery. It is important therefore that deployed responders are experienced on CfW and have a good understanding of how it fits within the recovery process.

Later on, the MCO developed a **Joint Programme** with other UN agencies. This choice, however, presented several difficulties. In addition to being a complex collaboration among UN agencies, ILO and UN-Habitat did not have a presence in country; a JP is not the best format for immediate response or early recovery, that require rapid implementation; as reported, activities were not always consulted properly with stakeholders; informants report that the JP presented some structural design weaknesses.

Several of the project proposals reviewed (CERF and ER ones) do not have a solid **gender equality approach**, but rather include partial solutions such as an equal number of male and female beneficiaries. This is not sufficient and does not contribute much to promote gender equality if it's not accompanied by other, more comprehensive interventions. These will vary depending on the context, but always start with a gender analysis (that can be done as part of the preparedness work of the CO), and an identification of key gender issues in the country, for example gender-based violence, discrimination in the work place, lack of access to means of production, etc. Based on the analysis, the MCO can identify response strategies and actions that address both practical and strategic needs. The IASC and many humanitarian actors have developed several useful resources on gender in crisis response; UNDP itself is in the process of developing guidance on gender and recovery.

4. Successes and challenges of the response

4.1. Key successes of the response and enabling factors

Several factors contributed to TC Pam response; they are discussed in the report and summarized below :

Corporate support (HQ and RH) and activation of crisis response mechanisms - Corporate support was convened quickly and it was dedicated and positive; with particular mention of the support provided by the Desk Officer in the Regional Hub. Activation of Fast Track Procedures and SOPs and release of immediate funds for Vanuatu were beneficial to kick-start the response. The CB effectively channeled support from multiple units and departments.

Immediate internal resource mobilization – UNDP corporately (RBAP, CRU and BPPS) provided funds of USD 50,000, USD 350,000 and USD 476,000 (total of USD 876,000) which allowed the MCO to establish an office in Vanuatu and initiate immediate crisis response activities and coordination.

High quality and skills of staff deployed - Deployments provided UNDP with much needed capacity, particularly in Vanuatu; some of the staff deployed have been commended repeatedly as competent, knowledgeable and effective.

High quality and skills of MSB deployments – Ample consensus on quality and skills of the personnel deployed through MSB and their effectiveness even in short-term assignments.

Support provided by MCO staff – Positive contribution of local staff, advising technical experts on the local context and on how to adapt standard solutions to the reality of the country. Good collaboration between MCO staff and incoming responders. In particular, excellent performance reported of the Operations Manager deployed to Vanuatu, later recommended for SURGE deployments.

Rapid scale up of Vanuatu operation and stronger presence in country – Expansion of UNDP office in Vanuatu and establishment of a Vanuatu Special Desk in MCO, increase in staff and programme coherence and team work in Vanuatu, leading to a stronger operation and programme implementation.

Humanitarian leadership and Humanitarian coordination – Immediate appointment of the Humanitarian Coordinator and regular presence in country, positively recognized including by UNDAC. Strong support and civil-military coordination with FRANZ (France, Australia, New Zealand).

4.2. Key gaps and challenges

The TC Pam response presented multiple challenges; they are discussed in the report and the most important ones are highlighted below:

Collective UNDP mobilization was not particularly rapid, several delays and difficulties in the very first days after the cyclone did not contribute to a rapid mobilization of the organization.

Limited presence in Vanuatu and lack of senior representation in Vanuatu office – This was the key initial challenge faced by the MCO. A very limited presence before the disaster, and multiple factors afterwards led to a void in leadership and representation in Vanuatu, which affected in particular UNDP's representation and its resource mobilization efforts.

Lack of preparedness of the MCO – The Fiji MCO did not have a preparedness plan and was not ready to face the multiple challenges posed by TC Pam operation.

Delay in first responders' deployments – Competing engagements and some uncertainties on the new mechanisms following the corporate restructuring delayed the identification and deployment of first responders. This in turn affected the participation to assessments, the technical support to proposal development and resource mobilization, the time allowed for the elaboration of the SURGE Plan.

Limited continuity in SURGE support – Fragmented or short deployments, not replaced after departure, have limited the continuity of the support to the MCO, and in turn the continuity of UNDP's support to the country. In particular for Early Recovery, these issues and the high turnover led to a perception of insufficient technical guidance on ER.

Unsuccessful resource mobilization for humanitarian and recovery funds - The organization was not able to mobilize humanitarian funds. Reasons include the perception of limited UNDP's capacities as a crisis response actor, the classification of its activities as not "life-saving", the lack of an authoritative voice advocating for UNDP's proposals, and delays in developing proposals for a bilateral donor. The external fundraising for the Joint Programme proposal for recovery activities also failed.

Some other challenges have contributed:

Limited knowledge of corporate crisis response and tools – Before TC Pam, some members of the MCO management and staff did not have extended knowledge of corporate crisis response, tools and resources available; training and an increased CO preparedness could have been beneficial.

Quality of programming – The gender equality approach in some of the proposals analyzed is limited; technical support from HQ or RH could have mitigated these difficulties. The Cash for Work approach appears to have been controversial at the beginning and not immediately accepted at local level; in the end, however, the MCO was able to adapt the approach to the local context.

Challenges linked to the context – The remoteness of the area and distance of islands caused difficult movements and a high cost of programming, even for a small emergency. The time difference affected communication and coordination with HQ and RH. After a few weeks, the earthquake in Nepal also diverted resources from other crises, including from the Pacific. The Government of Vanuatu was very keen on taking the lead and having maximum visibility, and requested that all donor funding be channeled through national structures. Since the Government did not advocate for assistance and advisory support from the UN, resource mobilization of the UN, including UNDP, remained limited. The focus on Vanuatu, who took the brunt of the cyclone, grossly limited any chances to raise funds and develop activities in Tuvalu, even if UNDP led the joint UN presence in Tuvalu, the government appealed for international support immediately and had a very positive relation with UNDP.

5. Conclusions and Recommendations

This AAR concludes that UNDP's response to TC Pam was activated immediately and to the right degree both at corporate level and in country; however, some of the internal mechanisms for corporate support to the MCO – such as funds allocation and deployments – did not function as expected. The MCO structure and the absence of a preparedness approach had a negative impact on the response and on UNDP's capacity to mobilize resources, limiting *de facto* the possibility for significant recovery activities, once the initial emergency phase subsided. The initial response and immediate programme effort (in particular debris management) was successful, but it did not lead to medium and longer-term recovery engagement for UNDP.

The following recommendations aim at improving specific elements of the MCO – now Pacific Office in Fiji - performance, while recommendations for UNDP reach beyond the individual case and aim at improving the corporate capacity to prepare for and respond to crises.

5.1. Recommendations for UNDP

Resource Mobilization and Advocacy: Resource mobilization is a vital priority. Without resources, UNDP's response and recovery activities can be severely reduced. Other evaluations and AARs have indicated the importance of resource mobilization and how to take advantage of the limited opportunities UNDP might have. In the immediate aftermath of a disaster, a CO is very busy with the response and has many competing priorities to address; RM and proposal writing should be made as easy as possible.

- ✓ Treat RM as a high-level priority since the beginning of the response; beyond keeping it as a standing agenda point in CB meetings, COs should be provided with detailed guidance and resources, for example with thematic RM packages within the CRPs.
- ✓ Support the country offices with a RM Advisor as first responder (preferably deployed to the CO but if not possible, remotely) and a RM strategy, for all L2 and L3 crises;
- ✓ Review the existing mechanism to allocate immediate resources for crisis response to ensure its effectiveness and rapidity; consider a no-regrets approach for immediate release of funds;
- ✓ Profile donors: identify their funding priorities and interest, both thematic and geographic, preferred channels for funding (i.e. multilateral or bilateral); consider non-traditional donors (for example Russia, Kuwait, China, Kazakhstan); support COs by investigating and providing information on possible non-traditional resources;
- ✓ Engage with donors in non-disaster times, show UNDP's potential when it has sufficient resources (particularly on ER) and how this supports the entire response;
- ✓ Provide detailed guidance to COs on how to advocate for early recovery activities as life-saving, essential in the immediate response, or directly contributing to life-saving activities;
- ✓ Within the humanitarian system, stress UNDP's role in crisis management at global and (where necessary) country level; refine how the organization's role is presented and represented; discuss humanitarian funding criteria and how part of UNDP's activities fall under them.
- ✓ Conduct selected return on investment (ROI) analyses in next crises responses to identify the potential for resource mobilization of each initial response action (disbursement of funds via TRAC or PIP, deployment of first responders, direct RM investments and so on);
- ✓ Conduct an in-depth reflection, backed by research and data, on cost-opportunity for resource mobilization and engagement in early recovery rather than longer-term recovery and reconstruction, to determine an evidence-based position of the organization on the opportunity of each of them.

Immediate crisis support: Refine existing corporate measures to support COs responding to an emergency.

- ✓ Include Before Action Reviews (BAR) in the new SOPs as a practice to be conducted within the first couple of CB meetings;
- ✓ Verify that any office in crisis has a Head of Office with sufficient seniority, preferably from the MCO. If this condition is not fulfilled, discuss with the MCO pertinent measures to address the gap;
- ✓ To facilitate coherence and coordination on the support HQ and Regional Hubs provide, identify focal points both at HQ and RHs on specific areas of work, like Local

Governance, Livelihoods/Economic Recovery, Assessments including PDNAs/PCNAs, Interagency ER Coordination and others as pertinent;³⁴

- ✓ Clarify respective roles of BPPS, RH/RPPS, CRU and the Desk Officers in country support, to avoid duplications and potential conflicting advice, and to make stronger use of the resources available within the organization.
- ✓ Include in the new SOPs a mandatory review – around one month in the response – of the strategy, progress and challenges. The review should be a separate event (not a regular coordination meetings) to allow for proper reflection, and involve RH and HQ. The review should be repeated regularly, at least every three months.
- ✓ Include in the Crisis Response Packages a recommendation for rigorous assessment of the Cash for Work potential in each context and a recommendation for in-depth consultation with communities and local authorities to determine its viability and potential risks (such as disruption of existing social and community practices);

Deployments: Deployments of First Responders and SURGE Advisors are one of the most important and most effective tools of corporate support to crisis management. It is essential for UNDP to find the right formula for the implementation of the First Responders Business Practice, in a way that addresses potential competing priorities within the organization.

- ✓ Include a Senior Recovery Advisor in the ‘standard package’ of First Responders in any crisis, as required expertise to support COs in conceptualizing and developing UNDP’s role in the short, medium and long-term;
- ✓ Include Early Recovery Advisors in the First Responders standard deployment package, clearly identify their strategic contributions and reflect them in ToRs;
- ✓ Include in the first responders standard deployment package for MCOs a profile to support the MCO’s management capacity, so that management can temporarily focus on the emergency while ensuring continued attention to non-affected countries; the same provision should be accorded to all COs when affected by a major crisis (automatically for L3 crises, upon decision for L2 crises);
- ✓ Provide incentives (for example on performance evaluation, or opportunities for professional development) to staff to be included in the First Responders Roster and incentives for staff and managers to ensure rapid deployment.

Preparedness and capacity building: Preparedness is an essential element of an organization’s capacity to respond. In the absence of a corporate policy on preparedness, COs approach to their own preparedness will be uneven and could be technically insufficient. Preparedness also applies to HQ and RHs as it can enhance their capacity to support COs affected by crises.

- ✓ Instate a corporate policy of minimum CO preparedness, for low- medium- and high-risk countries. Minimum preparedness levels should be monitored annually and included as criteria for annual management evaluation.
- ✓ Establish an Early Warning service for HQ and RHs to alert key staff and offices/units of potential impending crises likely to reach L2 or L3 level.³⁵ Alternatively, adhere to similar services provided by other organizations (like GDACS, HEWS).
- ✓ Prepare for the possibility that multiple countries of an MCO are affected by a crisis, and that the MCO will require double/triple support in terms of first responders and SURGE deployments;

³⁴ Current draft of the new Corporate SOPs address this recommendation.

³⁵ Included in the new draft SOP as one of the triggers for crisis board meeting #1 and crisis declaration.

- ✓ Given the increasing vulnerability of countries to disaster, the growing frequency and severity of crises, train all RRs/RCs, Deputy RRs and Country Directors on the corporate approach and mechanisms for crisis response, early recovery and recovery; orient them on recovery coordination and global processes that unfold after disasters (e.g. Flash Appeals, CERF, PDNA).
- ✓ Develop simulations or scenario-based exercises presenting common challenges (for example advocacy and resource mobilization on early recovery in an unsupportive context, shifting or unclear government priorities on response and recovery, and others) to expose senior managers to these challenges and their possible solutions;
- ✓ In support to CO preparedness, provide guidance on potential strategic results in the immediate response phase (i.e. position UNDP as ER leader organization) and on required profiles, including mixed profiles, to achieve them;
- ✓ Develop in advance ToRs of likely profiles to be deployed (from stand-by partners, internal or external rosters) based on the typical team composition that can respond to the majority of disasters, include them in CRPs;
- ✓ Identify capable local staff in countries prone to emergencies, train them on crisis response rules and regulations and provide them with the knowledge and experience, through secondments or missions, to be 'assets' in crisis response in their own CO or as SURGE responders;
- ✓ Include soft skills as one of the selection criteria for first responders and SURGE Advisors deployment, and develop soft skills module as part of the First Responders and SURGE Advisors training;
- ✓ Develop an internal roster of debris management specialists, to be deployed as first responders until MSB experts arrive.

5.2. Recommendations for the Pacific Office in Fiji (former MCO)

The following recommendations are aimed at the Pacific Country Office, however many could also apply to other COs in disaster prone countries.

Preparedness: The Pacific Office in Fiji includes many countries that are prone to disasters and it has the additional challenge of being a multi-country office, with the consequences we have seen on presence on the ground. For these reasons, we strongly recommend that it develops a comprehensive preparedness plan.

- ✓ Elaborate a preparedness and response plan, which includes:
 - Likely scenarios, such as disasters in one or more countries, and the different implications if the disaster is in Fiji or elsewhere;
 - Plans for multi-country / management level when a disaster strikes in one or more countries other than Fiji, and complementary brief individual response plans for each country;
 - A deployment plan of MCO staff to address the scenarios identified, with priority given to a Head of Office and a coordination officer;
 - A list of MCO "first responders" for immediate deployment and a second wave of staff, able to remain deployed for a longer time (at least 3-6 months);
 - Surge support and profiles likely required (depending on the scenarios identified) and ToRs of potential surge; these could be ER Advisors, PDNA Specialists, Livelihoods Advisors or others, or some position that covers multiple roles; think strategically what results these profiles should achieve and develop draft ToRs accordingly;

- A joint plan with other UN agencies for representation in case of disaster where there is a Joint UN Presence;
- Preparedness and immediate response needs for Programmes and Operations
- Prepositioned supplies for crisis response packages (based on cost-benefit analysis);
- Stand-by agreements with partners for crisis response;
- Long Term Agreements with local suppliers, for materials and equipment sourced in local markets (as a complement or an alternative to pre-positioning);
- Training for staff and if pertinent for partners on crisis management, humanitarian programming cycle and early recovery.

Position UNDP for response and early recovery: during non-disaster times, engage in internal and external actions to strengthen UNDP's position and image as a reliable crisis response partner.

- ✓ During non-disaster times, engage in dialogue, awareness raising and education of Governments, partners and donors on Early Recovery and its importance for crisis response;
- ✓ Engage with the humanitarian community in country (for example the Pacific Humanitarian Team, or the Vanuatu Humanitarian Team and other country-specific mechanisms), to position UNDP as a response and recovery actor, to raise awareness on Early Recovery and on its implications in humanitarian response and for recovery;
- ✓ Engage with country teams and governments to agree on the elements of a potential Early Recovery Cluster (e.g. national counterpart agency, member agencies of the ER cluster, programmatic mandate of the ER Cluster in terms of sectors and projects that it could undertake and so on);
- ✓ Position the organization for disaster response through programming. When designing regular programmes and projects, take into consideration the likely disaster scenarios and crisis response and recovery needs; reflect on how to align or adapt programme activities so that they could be converted or built-upon in crisis response, early recovery and recovery (for example a regular programme on waste management, can be converted to an emergency response project on debris management);
- ✓ Map existing programmes for potential entry points on crisis response and in case of disasters, use these entry points to kick-start the response.

Resource mobilization: in addition to resource mobilization during emergencies, engage with potential donors before disasters to create a conducive environment for future funding.

- ✓ Engage with donors locally, during non-disaster times, to show UNDP's role and potential in emergencies and how it can contribute to response and early recovery;
- ✓ Discuss with donors about RM that takes place in the first weeks after a disaster but it should not be only about immediate crisis response; open a dialogue on the linkages with long-term recovery and how to connect RM for the two phases;
- ✓ Agree with donors when designing programmes what resources can be used for immediate disaster response in case of an emergency (ex. 5% of the total or similar);

During response:

- ✓ At the beginning of the response, conduct a brief "Before Action Review" to identify the most important risks the operation could face (See How to conduct a BAR in Annex 6.6) and how to mitigate them;

- ✓ Ensure the immediate deployment (if capacity is not sufficient in country) of a Head of Office and a Coordination Specialist; consider the need for a Resource Mobilization Advisor;
- ✓ Ensure the immediate deployment of an Early Recovery Advisor (if capacity is not sufficient in country) with clear strategic and programmatic goals reflected in his/her ToRs;
- ✓ Strengthen credibility as a response actor: consolidate the image and work of UNDP on the ground, develop a solid conceptual and operational approach in the response, document it and share it, demonstrate to Governments, partners and donors that the organization can deliver;
- ✓ Deliver key messages to media and external stakeholders on the role of UNDP in crisis response;
- ✓ Conduct a review – around one month in the response – of the strategy, progress and challenges; review if initial ToRs of staff deployed, surge and consultants are still relevant or if they should be updated, ensure that any changes are communicated to all staff. Conduct the review as a separate event (not as a regular coordination meetings) to allow for proper reflection, and with the participation of the RH and HQ. Repeat the review regularly, every three months at least.

6. Annexes

6.1. ToRs of the consultancy

Terms of Reference

Consultant – After Action Reviews for Crisis Response in Bosnia and Herzegovina floods and Cyclone PAM in Vanuatu, Crisis Response Unit – home based position

Duty Station :	HOME BASED
Languages Required :	English
Starting Date (date when the selected candidate is expected to start)	: Jan -2016
Duration of Initial Contract :	20 working days
Expected Duration of Assignment :	6 weeks
Background:	
UNDP's Strategic Plan (2014-2017) recognizes the importance of preparedness, response, early recovery and effective management of risk as fundamental for resilience building and development. The objective of the Crisis Response Unit (CRU) is to ensure that UNDP is well positioned to respond in the most timely and effective manner to crises, triggered by natural disasters or armed conflicts alike. CRU is responsible for UNDP's corporate crisis response strategy and capability. It develops and drives UNDP's vision and priorities for crisis response, coordinates and facilitates UNDP's crisis response with a whole-of-UNDP approach, provides oversight for all UNDP crisis response actions, supports early warning, guides corporate preparedness for crisis response, and manages UNDP's crisis response tools. UNDP's new corporate Crisis Response Strategy aims to make the Organization faster, more predictable and effective, and uses a "whole-of-UNDP" approach. As part of this Strategy UNDP is developing a series of 'Crisis Response Packages' that will allow the delivery of quick, effective and predictable interventions on the ground. Additionally, CRU is leading a corporate review of the UNDP Standard Operating Procedures (SOP) for crisis response. An After Action Reviews (hereafter AAR) of crisis response are considered routine and critical exercises to make recommendations for improving the efficiency and effectiveness of UNDP role and work on crisis response. AARs allows to reflect on and draw lessons on what happened, why it happened, what was learned, what follow-up action should be taken and how it can be done better next time. The purpose of AARs is to inform future projects and actions by identifying lessons and actionable recommendations, particularly in relation to the corporate SOP for crisis response and the crisis response packages. This consultancy will support the undertaking of two AARs for Bosnia Herzegovina (floods) and Cyclone PAM in Vanuatu. The AARs will be conducted on the phone and online with participation of critical stakeholders at country, regional and headquarters level. The methodology and format of the AARs is intentionally kept simple to allow a "light' review that is mainly informing the corporate revision of the SOP and the development of crisis response packages. The consultant is expected to carry out both AARs through a home based assignment, no travel to countries or UNDP headquarter is envisaged.	

Background, scope and objectives for Cyclone PAM AAR

Background

Tropical Cyclone Pam struck Vanuatu on the evening of 13 March 2015 at around 11.00 p.m. local time. The country is an archipelago of more than 80 islands with a projected population of 270,000 people according to 2015 national statistics' office calculations. The category 5 cyclone caused widespread damage across all six provinces of the archipelago – Malampa, Penama, Sanma, Shefa, Tafea, and Torba. Tropical Cyclone Pam's eye passed close to Efate Island in Sefa Province, where the capital Port Vila is located, with winds around 250 km/hr and gusts peaking at 320 km/hr. An estimated 166,600 people have been affected by the cyclone – more than half the country's population – and 11 fatalities have been reported.

UNDP's Immediate Response

At the time of Cyclone Pam hit Vanuatu, an updated UNDP's Crisis Response Accountability Framework was still under discussion and not yet finalized, and the Standard Operating Procedures for Immediate Crisis Response (SOPs) were not yet updated to reflect UNDP's Structural Change. Meanwhile, the first Crisis Board (CB) meeting was organized on 16 March 2015, which decided to manage the crisis response as Level 2, making Regional Bureau for Asia and Pacific (RBAP) to lead the coordination of response. A Crisis Management Team (CMT) was also established in April 2015.

Immediately following Cyclone Pam, UNDP was able to send a team of first responders to support the Multi-country Office (MCO). The team included two recovery advisors, a debris removal expert, a communications specialist and a crisis response coordination specialist to advise the MCO. With the first responder's support, the MCO developed a UNDP SURGE Plan for the period April to June 2015, which was submitted and approved by the CB on 9 April 2015.

Objective

As the custodian of UNDP's immediate crisis response mechanisms, CRU will facilitate the After Action Review / Lessons Learnt exercise, in close collaboration with the Regional Bureau for Asia-Pacific and all other bureaux involved. A CRU staff member not involved in the immediate response to Tropical Cyclone Pam will be assigned to facilitate the exercise.

The purpose of the AAR for UNDPs Immediate Response to Tropical Cyclone Pam is to inform UNDP's future immediate crisis response by identifying lessons and actionable recommendations. The AAR is not a performance review. It should be conducted in a spirit of openness and learning and encourage honest evaluation by practitioners. The conduct of an After Action Review (AAR) is part of the deactivation phase of UNDP's immediate crisis response following a disaster or conflict.

Specifically, AAR for UNDPs Immediate Response to Tropical Cyclone Pam aim to:

- Record what has worked and what has not worked in UNDP's immediate crisis response;
- Ascertain whether existing SOPs for Immediate Crisis Response were adhered to (if not why and what deviations took place and why)
- Reflect on whether the applied resources, processes and mechanisms have led to the desired impact and outputs;
- Identify recommendations to improve UNDPs crisis response SOPs and other corporate crisis response tools

Occurring in the first half of 2015, the immediate crisis response to Tropical Cyclone Pam offers valuable lessons on how UNDP's existing procedures have been applied in the context of the revised corporate structure of UNDP. It will also serve to feed into the currently ongoing revision of the Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) for UNDP's Immediate Crisis Response. The AAR could provide useful insights on the deployment of first responders, setup of an early recovery cluster, addressing time critical needs of disaster affected communities – including the creation of temporary employment through labor intensive schemes to support debris management and

rehabilitation of community infrastructure. These insights will feed into the revision of UNDP's Fast Track Procedures, as well as the finalization/implementation of UNDP's crisis response packages on emergency livelihoods, national recovery planning and coordination.

Background, scope and objectives for Bosnia and Herzegovina response to 2014 floods

Background and Scope

In the aftermath of the devastating floods in Bosnia and Herzegovina in Spring 2014 UNDP was actively involved in time critical activities such as debris and rubble removal, recycling, and disposal; this included the safe removal of hazardous and health threatening waste (e.g. animal carcasses). UNDP interventions were funded by humanitarian financing instruments providing much needed seed funding to kick start early recovery and time critical activities. For instance, CERF grants benefitted more 560,000 people in Bosnia and Herzegovina that were able to rapidly regain access to essential services like water and sewage. Importantly, UNDP initiatives adopted an early recovery approach that bridged relief and recovery interventions allowing a rapid transition back to a development pathway³⁶. In Bosnia and Herzegovina, CERF grants represented an important seed funding to the organization that successfully mobilized substantial resources for its recovery programming allowing a much needed transition between relief and recovery and return to development activities. UNDP Bosnia received approximately 1.2 million USD CERF grant and managed to mobilize more than 48.5 million USD for recovery of the floods affected districts and municipalities.

UNDP Bosnia and Herzegovina also managed to rapidly design and implement early recovery projects with time critical and lifesaving impact on crisis affected communities.

Objective

Document lessons learned and best practices on immediate crisis response with a particular focus on adopted procedures and coordination, linking programme and operations, setting up and implementing early recovery projects, bridging time critical activities and recovery planning at municipal and local level.

The following agenda items will be discussed:

- Coordination of Corporate Crisis Response Support
- Crisis Response Deployments (SURGE advisors, ExpRes Consultants, Stand By Partners)
- Emergency Grant Allocations (TRAC 113 Cat. 2 resources for coordination and assessment, CPR TTF allocation for programming, CERF Rapid Response Grant),
- Support for Early Recovery Coordination (including through the deployment of early recovery advisors and cluster coordinators as well as support for the establishment the cluster system)
- Support for Assessment
- Support for Programme Development / Initiation of support as well as linkages with medium to Longer-term Recovery initiatives
- Support for Resource Mobilization
- Operational Support (including Fast Track Activation and Utility)

Key issues to be addressed should include the following:

- Timing of the response activities
- Adequacy and relevance of the response
- Effectiveness and quality of the activities
- Coherence of UNDP's activities, in the context of the overall UN response
- Impact of the response and sustainability of activities

³⁶ For instance, in Bosnia and Herzegovina mine action accompanied debris management activities and emergency employment was generated for more than 600 people from poor and vulnerable households affected by the floods.

- Recommendations for the review of corporate policies and procedures on crisis response
- Key operational challenges for delivering quick results

The information collected in the AAR will inform the revision of the UNDP Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) for immediate crisis response, the revision of the Fast Track and the development/finalization of all UNDP crisis response packages, particularly the two packages on emergency livelihoods (i) debris, municipal solid waste and community infrastructure; (ii) emergency employment and enterprise recovery ones.

Description of Responsibilities :

Under the direct supervision of the Programme Specialist (Rapid Response and Preparedness Team) the Consultant will:

1. Contribute to development of questionnaire and methodology for both AARs exercises.
2. Participate in both AARs exercises through phone or Skype, take notes from the interviews with critical stakeholders. When relevant or needed interview bilaterally stakeholders who could not join the AAR exercises.
3. Produce the reports for both AARs to be submitted to the UNDP Crisis Response Unit.

6.2. Timeline of events

EXTERNAL OR INTERAGENCY	DATE	UNDP
	MARCH	
TC Pam strucks Vanuatu at about 11.00 pm local time (Cat.5)	13-Mar-15	
GoV requests international assistance	15-Mar	
GoV expresses need for a light assessment and starts its own led by ministries	15-Mar	
Deployment of UNDAC mission	16-Mar	
	17-Mar	The RC/RR was designated HC for a period of 3 months
	17-Mar	First CB meeting Chaired in Bangkok by Deputy RD of RBAP. Agrees on L2 crisis. Importance of highlighting early recovery and including it in funding appeals; LL from Philippines: if resource mobilization opportunity is missed, there is no second round. Requests to MCO to identify additional resources needed. Agrees on USD 50,000 from RBAP for immediate expenses; agrees on Fast Track procedures approval; requests TRAC 3 proposal for 19/03 and two pagers for Japan by 20/03
Initial Rapid Assessments undertaken by UNDAC	17-22 Mar	
	18-Mar	RR/RC/HC goes to Vanuatu (UNDAC Report: HC almost immediately deployed to Port Vila for an extended period to lead and coordinate UN and implementing partner efforts in support of the Government led response.)
	18-Mar	RBAP released 50,000 USD for MCO for response
	18-19 Mar	Fast track approval for Vanuatu and Tuvalu
	19-Mar	TRAC 1.1.3 allocation of 350,000 USD to MCO for assessment, coordination of response for Vanuatu, Tuvalu and Kiribati and initiating early recovery frameworks

	19-Mar	Recovery Adviser (MacDonald Kadzatsa) working in Fiji MCO/Pacific Centre deployed to Tuvalu and reassigned for 3 months to Tuvalu
	19-Mar	DRR/Recovery Adviser (Zubair Murshed) deployed for 2 weeks – deliverables: Flash Appeal, CERF, Joint Program
	22-Mar	Programme Coordinator of PRRP (Moortaza Jiwanji) deployed to Vanuatu for 1 week to work on UNDP recovery programming
	22-Mar	Operations, logistics and procurement staff start rotating from Fiji MCO in Suva to Port Vila on a weekly basis
	Date TBD	Special desk for Vanuatu set up in MCO, supporting all the operation
	23-Mar	Debris Removal Expert (Tim Walsh) deployed for 4 weeks; deliverables: jump start Cash for Work activities
	23/24 Mar	Second CB meeting Requests proposal for seed funding to BPPS. (1) Vanuatu: Senior Recovery Advisor for 3 months (2) Tuvalu: Senior Recovery Advisor who knows UNDP and can also handle UN coordination for potential Flash Appeal for 3 months (3) Vanuatu and Suva: Programme Specialist to prepare and implement Flash Appeal project on recovery (UN Joint Programme) (4) Vanuatu: UNDP Head of Office to also cover representation, donor relations, inter-agency etc. and help establish UNDP office for 3 -6 months, to be converted into regular post funded from recovery projects in the future (5) Tuvalu: Debris Management Specialist (3-4 weeks) (can be consultant or from roster) (6) Suva: Detailed assignment to support MCO programmes in remaining 8 countries . Request for Surge Plan by next CB meeting
Flash Appeal launched for almost 30 mln USD, of which 2.3 mln for ER, of which 1.9 mln for UNDP submission on community infrastructure, debris clearance, livelihoods for youth and women and EW for seasonal hazards	24-Mar	
CERF process and submission	25-26 March	
	27-Mar	Communication Specialist (Silke Von Brockhausen) deployed for 6 weeks; deliverables: visibility of RC/HC and MCO on Early Recovery

	27-Mar	DRR/Recovery Advisor (Karen Bernard) deployed for 4 weeks; deliverable: PDNA and MIRA assessments
	27-Mar	Program Specialist (Asmaa Shalabi) deployed for 2.5 weeks; deliverables: SURGE Plan, Crisis Response Coordination
	Date TBD	WB in coordination with Prime Minister's Office agree on a light PDNA based on the DALA
	Date TBD	The HCT agreed on a MIRA II to update the Flash Appeal
	30-Mar	BPPS BPAC endorses a PIP for Cash for Work and Debris Clearance for USD 476,664for Vanuatu Total budget USD 506,604. Timeframe April 2015-April 2016. Part of the Joint Programme Direct Implementation. Outputs: 1. Cash income for equal number of men and women in 2 affected communities for 1 month; 2. Debris cleared, sorted and disposed of; 3. Local carpentry workshop established.
GoV insists on quick PDNA and sent official request; PDNA to start on 6 Apr and Karen Bernard (UNDP) will join	31-Mar	
Second phase assessments	31 Mar-8 Apr	
Second phase assessment Shefa and Tafea	31 Mar – 2 Apr	
	APRIL	
	01-Apr	Third Crisis Board meeting – first draft of SURGE Plan approved (final version dated 15 April) Surge Plan approved. Request to Fiji MCO to develop and share concept notes for resource mobilization. Decision to establish Crisis Management Team. Request for a PIP proposal for Tuvalu to be submitted to BPPS. Recommends to include longer term livelihoods restoration, beyond debris management and C4Work and service delivery by local governments.
	06-Apr	RR/RC/HC back to Vanuatu for 1 week
Second phase assessment Penama and Malampa	7-8 Apr	
Assessment report Shefa and Tafea	08-Apr	
	9-10 Apr	Fourth CB meeting Agrees to deploy Sanny and Francisco to ensure UNDP positioning in Early Recovery and

		livelihoods as foundation for long term recovery; finalize UNDP recovery vision paper (was this done?) and respond to Govt request for technical advice on Economic Recovery; also help CO in finalizing 2 pagers for resource mobilization
	14-Apr	TORs for HQ Crisis Management Team. Composition: MCO, CRU, BPPS, RPPS, Pacific Centre, BERA, BOM, RBAP • Manage organizational support to the Fiji Multi-Country Office (MCO) throughout the response, ensuring whenever possible minimal burdens of administrative transaction, information management, and coordination on the MCO; • Coordinate with the MCO Management Team (MCOMT) and interface with all relevant HQ and Bangkok Regional Hub units the provision of any immediate guidance and support required; • Act as the main and primary channel for communication and information sharing between HQ/BRH and the MCOMT; • Lead on the preparation of information and analysis (through briefs, updates, reports and other documents) as required by the Crisis Board to support decision-making, and strategic internal and external communication and engagement with donor governments and other stakeholders at the global, regional, and country levels. • Assess the MCO capacity to effectively respond to the crisis (incl. its managerial, programmatic and operational Effectiveness); • Identify the necessary measures for building the MCO capacities in close collaboration with the CO Crisis Response Team and senior management; • Keep the CB informed on risks and issues for their decision making as outlined in TORs
	Date TBD	SURGE Recovery Advisor deployed
	Date TBD	Deployment of a Recovery Advisor to develop Recovery Vision and align UNDP programmes with the Joint Action Plan (JAP)
	15-Apr	UNDP SURGE Plan finalized
World Bank and UNDP conduct a PDNA in Shefa, Tafea, Penama, Malampa	15-Apr	
Comprehensive 2 nd phase assessment report	16-Apr	
Consultation cluster leads about Joint Action Plan	17-Apr	
Cluster leads develop cluster response plans	17-20 Apr	

	21-Apr	UNDP launches the Waste Management and Livelihood Recovery initiative in Vanuatu (2000+ direct beneficiaries) Solar lanterns procured through ongoing Vanuatu Community Resilience programme, handed to communities as part of the Emergency Kit distributed to 12 project sites.
Revision of Flash Appeal	17-21 Apr	
UNDAC Mission report	20-Apr	
Joint Action Plan for Humanitarian Response and Early Recovery	23-Apr	
PDNA completed and presented to PM and Ministers	23-Apr	
	23-24 Apr	Fifth and final CB meeting Agreed to end CBM unless requested by MCO or HQ; Francisco's deployment extended; RM meetings by BERA and HC; separate BPPS MCO discussion on Tuvalu PIP
Govt Response Plan	27-Apr	
	Date TBD	UNDP Office in Vanuatu: Bigger space in the joint facility for 12 months: 4 UNDP staff already on board, 1 driver, 2 additional SURGE staff.
	Date TBD	Submission of a Cash for Work proposal USD 300,000 to BPPS/BPAC for Tuvalu (BUT NOT FUNDED)
	Date TBD	Development of the CPRRP (Joint Programme) with ILO, UN Women, UNV, UN Habitat (BUT NOT FUNDED)
MAY		
Launch of the Humanitarian Action Plan (HAP) replaces the Flash Appeal – USD 700K for Early Recovery	01-May	
Donors' Conference	Date TBD	
	Date TBD	SURGE UN Coordination Specialist deployed to Tuvalu
GoT planning to prepare a national Post Disaster Recovery Plan	Date TBD	
JUNE		
Transition from HAP to the Govt Strategic Action Plan (SAP)	Date TBD	

6.3. List of people interviewed

The following persons were interviewed or provided written inputs during the information collection phase:

Name	Designation	Office
Bruno Lemarquis	Director	Crisis Response Unit
Bettina Woll	Crisis Response Coordinator (Asia-Pacific, Arab States, Europe and the CIS)	Crisis Response Unit
Fabrizio Andreuzzi	Programme Specialist – Rapid Response and Preparedness	Crisis Response Unit
Thierry Proteau		Crisis Response Unit
Nicholas Rosellini	Deputy Regional Director	Regional Bureau Asia Pacific
Asmaa Shalabi	Programme Specialist	Crisis Response Unit
Zubair Murshed	Programme Specialist	Regional Hub Amman
Naoko Takasu	Country Programme Specialist, Desk officer	Regional Bureau for Asia Pacific
Francisco Santos Jara-Padrón	Regional Programme Advisor on Livelihoods	Regional Bureau for Asia Pacific / RPPS
Devanand Ramiah	Head of South East Asia & Pacific Cluster	Regional Bureau for Asia Pacific
Osnat Lubrani	Resident Representative/Resident Coordinator	Fiji MCO
Akiko Fujii	Deputy Resident Representative	Fiji MCO
Asenaca Ravuvu	Assistant Resident Representative Programmes	Fiji MCO
Tim Walsh	Debris/Waste Management Recovery Advisor	MSB
Marc Antoine Morel	Recovery Coordinator	Fiji MCO

6.4. Participants and guidelines for the AAR Conference Calls

Participants to Asia AAR

Name	Designation	Office
Osnat Lubrani	Resident Representative / Resident Coordinator	Fiji MCO – now Pacific Office
Akiko Fujii	Deputy Resident Representative	Fiji MCO – now Pacific Office
Asenaca Ravuvu	Assistant Resident Representative Programmes	Fiji MCO
Donald Wouloseje	Programme Officer	Vanuatu
Marc-Antoine Morel	Recovery Coordinator	Fiji MCO

Tim Walsh	Debris/Waste Management Recovery Advisor	MSB
Sanny Jegillos	Regional Disaster Reduction Adviser	Regional Bureau for Asia Pacific

Participants to NYC AAR

Name	Designation	Office
Sitara Syed	Programme Specialist, CO Liaison and Coordination	Regional Bureau for Asia-Pacific
Rita Missal	Policy Specialist, Post-Disaster Recovery Support	Bureau for Programme and Policy Support
Bettina Woll	Crisis Response Coordinator (Asia-Pacific, Arab States, Europe and the CIS)	Crisis Response Unit
Yasu Doken	Policy Specialist (Crisis Liaison), Integration and Coordination Support Unit, Directorate	Bureau for Programme and Policy Support

Guidelines for AAR calls

Agenda and AAR guidelines – TC Pam (22 April HQ / 25 April Fiji MCO)

1. Introductions.

Introductions of participants, purpose and scope of the AAR and process for this meeting [5 minutes]

2. Before starting, is there any factual correction, comment or addition you would like to make to the Initial findings? [5 minutes].

3. Corporate support (HQ and RB/RH) to crisis response:

3a. Crisis Board [35 minutes]

- There was a slight delay in the mobilization of the 1st CB. [10 minutes]
 - Why?
 - What was the impact?
 - What do you recommend for new SOPs?
- Crisis was classified as L2 [5 minutes]
 - What criteria?
 - In hindsight, was it the right choice?
 - Any recommendations for new SOPs?
- CB multiple communications reportedly leading to inefficiencies and conflicting priorities [10 minutes]
 - Any specific issue that can be corrected?
 - Delay in appointing CMT. Why?
 - Is there a need for better identification and communication of response priorities? Any recommendations?
 - New SOPs establish communication focal point to avoid communications issues. Anything else for new SOPs?
- SURGE Plan deadline. [10 minutes]

- Why was the deadline not changed?
- What impact does the quality of the SURGE Plan have on the response?
- Any recommendations for new SOPs?

3b. Deployments [30 minutes]

- There was a delay in deployment of First Responders because of conflicting priorities. [10 minutes]
 - What mechanism is in place now to establish priority among conflicting demands?
 - Any recommendations to avoid delays in the future? Any recommendations for new SOPs?
- Some profiles were not deployed, in particular the Head of Office, which had many consequences in terms of leadership, representation, RM etc. [10 minutes]
 - Why was this position not covered?
 - How does UNDP assess (if at all) the need for a leadership position in crisis management and what measures are in place to respond to the assessment?
 - Is this limited to MCOs or should also be considered for “normal” COs?
 - Any recommendations for new SOPs?
- Some continuity issues (immediate and longer term) with SURGE deployments and staff for SURGE Plan. [10 minutes]
 - Why positions were not replaced or added if necessary?
 - What recommendations to ensure sufficient dedicated technical guidance (ex on ER/Recovery like in this case)?
 - Any recommendations for new SOPs?

4. Resource mobilization [25 minutes]

- Immediate funding [5 minutes]
 - Did the MCO discuss with donors of existing programmes and projects the possibility of reassigning some funds for the emergency response? If so, what was the response and what the reasons given?
 - Tuvalu PIP - Why CO and BPPS invested time in a proposal that was not going to be funded (if BPPS did not have further resources)?
- Humanitarian funding [10 minutes]
 - What can UNDP for better positioning and results on CERF and other humanitarian funds?
 - With bilateral donors (ex. Japan)?
 - Any recommendations for new SOPs? For CRPs?
 - Should the organization have worked more on a RM strategy (as indicated in the SOPs)? Should a senior UNDP staff being tasked by the CB to follow up strategic actions/decisions, including RM? Should a Resource Mobilization Advisor be included in the standard initial response package?
- ER/Recovery funds [10 minutes]
 - What happened with DFAT and JP? Was a JP the right option in the situation? What could the organization have done to avoid this inefficiency? What to do differently next time?
 - Should the organization focus on RM for crisis response and early recovery, for longer-term recovery only, or both? Why?

5. MCO crisis response [15 minutes] [note these questions will be explored more in detail with the MCO than with HQ].

- Structure [5 minutes]

- Impact of MCO structure on crisis management. What recommendations in the future for MCOs?
- Any recommendation specific for MCOs to be included in CRPs and new SOPs?
- Programmes [5 minutes]
 - Did the MCO take advantage of existing programmes to start the response?
 - How were CfW activities conducted? Were they integrated in a longer-term recovery approach?
 - How was the gender equality approach integrated? Would a SURGE Gender Advisor have been useful?
 - What could be done differently next time?
- Preparedness [5 minutes]
 - What preparedness measures are recommended to better prepare MCOs for immediate crisis response?
 - What can be done specifically within the MCO to improve for next time?

6. Any final considerations? [5 minutes]

6.5. UNDP staff and Stand-By partners involved in the response

Name	Position	Unit/Bureau	Deployed to?	Start date	End date	Functions or remarks
Bruno Lemarquis	Director	CRU				CB
Bettina Woll	Crisis Response Coordinator	CRU				
Fabrizio Andreuzzi	Programme Specialist – Rapid Response and Preparedness	CRU				
Stan Nkwain	Deputy Director	BPPS				CB; Represent BPPS at CB and oversee support and response from BPPS NY
Owen Shumba	Team Leader, Livelihoods & Economic Recovery Team Sustainable Development Cluster	BPPS				Provide technical support for project proposal, expert selection as well as other materials, such as SURGE Plan
Rita Missal	Recovery Specialist, Climate Change and Disaster Risk Reduction Cluster	BPPS				Provide technical support, expert selection and coordinate PDNA at HQ level
Yasumitsu Doken	Policy Specialist (Crisis Liaison), Integration and Coordination Support Unit, Directrate	BPPS				Coordinate BPPS support, including fund allocation, and prepare and follow up for BPPS representation for CB.
Nick Rene Hartmann		BERA				CB
Notonegoro		BOM				CB, on behalf of BOM senior management
Nicholas Rosellini	Deputy Regional Director	RBAP				Chaired CB
Sitara Syed	Programme Specialist, CO Liaison and Coordination	RBAP				

Naoko Takasu	Country Programme Specialist, Desk officer	COSQAD, Bangkok Regional Hub		all along		Support to MCO
Devanand Ramiah		COSQAD, Bangkok Regional Hub				
Francisco Santos Padron	Regional Programme Advisor on Livelihoods / Recovery Advisor – Port Vila (P4). Early Recovery Advisor	RPPS	Vanuatu	Deployed to Vanuatu as soon as starting date confirmed by MCO	Initial deployment 1 mth, extended twice. Total approx 3,5 months	Initially ER Advisor, then changed
Sanny Ramos Jegillos	Senior Advisor, Disaster Risk Reduction and Recovery / ER Cluster Coordinator and Advisor (P5, 1 month)	Bangkok Regional Hub, RPPS	Vanuatu	Mid April	End April	Deployed briefly to MCO with missions in between; later redeployed to Nepal after earthquake
Peter Batchelor	Manager, Pacific Centre	Pacific Centre		involved initially		Pacific Centre, provides technical support to 15 Pacific Countries and territory under 3 offices, Fiji MCO, PNG CO and Samoa MCO. It has now been merged with other units and does not exist anymore.
Osnat Lubrani	RR/RC/HC Fiji MCO	UNCT / MCO		all along		
Akiko Fujii	Deputy RR	UNCT / MCO		all along		
Asenaca Ravuvu	Assistant Resident Representative - Programmes	MCO		all along		
Zubair Murshed	SURGE DRR/Recovery Advisor. Programme Specialist DRR Arab States	Regional Hub Amman/BPPS/ CDT	Fiji MCO / Suva	Arrives in Suva on 19/03	for 3 weeks, until beginning of April	DRR/Recovery Advisor (Zubair Murshed) deployed for 3 weeks - deliverables: Flash Appeal, CERF, Joint Program. ZM: to support the RC in recovery coordination, facilitate the operationalization of

MacDonald Kadzatsa Moortaza Jiwani Marc Antoine Morel Karen Bernard Tim Walsh Silke Von Brockhausen Asmaa Shalabi Ana Fonseca						PDNA and help UNDP office in recovery programme design;
	Recovery Advisor	Fiji MCO	Tuvalu	Goes to Tuvalu on 19/03	Until June	Recovery Adviser (MacDonald Kadzatsa) working in Fiji MCO/Pacific Centre deployed to Tuvalu and reassigned for 3 months to Tuvalu
	Programme Coordinator PRRP	Pacific Centre	Vanuatu	22-Mar	End March	Programme Coordinator of PRRP (Moortaza Jiwani) deployed to Vanuatu for 1 week to work on UNDP recovery programming
	Recovery Coordinator / Recovery Project Manager - Port Vila (P4)	Vanuatu	Vanuatu	Started on 1st April	Ended on 30 Sept	
	DRR Recovery Advisor	Eq. Guinea CO	Fiji	27-Mar	24 Apr	PDNA and MIRA Assessments
	Debris/Waste Management Recovery Advisor - Vanuatu	MSB	Vanuatu	23-Mar	28-Apr	Jump start cash for work activities / Assessment of debris situation with a view to securing funds for UNDP to design and implement a National Debris Mgmt Strategy
	Communications Specialist	BERA NY	Fiji MCO / Suva	27-Mar	6 weeks	Visibility of RC/HC and MCO on Early Recovery
	Programme Specialist	CRU	Fiji MCO / Vanuatu	27-Mar	2/3 weeks	SURGE Plan, Crisis response coordination
	Debris Management Advisor - Vanuatu (P4)	MSB	Vanuatu	12-Apr	22-May	

Faisal Ridwan	Debris Management Advisor - Vanuatu (P4)	MSB	Vanuatu	15-May	3rd June	
Camille Laude	Debris Management & Recovery Advisor - Tuvalu (P4)	MSB	Tuvalu	14 April	09 July	
Maria Garcia	UN Coordination Specialist (P3)	Colombia CO	Tuvalu	27th April 2015	for 3 months	

Members of the Crisis Board:

Chair: Nicholas Rosellini, RBAP
 Fiji MCO/Pacific Center: Osnat Lubrani
 RBAP New York: Elena Tischenko
 CRU New York: Bruno Lemarquis
 BPPS New York: Stan Nkwain
 BERA New York: Nick Rene Hartmann
 BOM New York: Notonegoro (on behalf of BOM senior management)

Members of the CMT:

Akiko Fujii, Rita Missal; Yasumitsu Doken ; Sanny Ramos Jegillos; Notonegoro; Peter Batchelor; Krishna Vatsa; Jelena Vladicic; Owen Shumba; Naoko Takasu; Sitara Syed ; Bettina Woll.

6.6. Before Action Review (BAR)

Before Action Review (BAR)

Adapted from *HBR Tools: After-Action Reviews*. Cambridge: Harvard Business School Publishing, 2015.

WHAT IS A BEFORE ACTION REVIEW?

A BAR is an exercise that helps a team to detect possible risks and challenges that a programme or project could face; to identify measures to manage such risks and to inform the planning accordingly.

WHEN TO DO IT?

The BAR should be conducted as soon as a programme/project is decided upon. In the case of emergency response, it should be conducted within the first 10 days of the disaster, for sudden-onset emergencies; for slow onset emergency or protracted crises, within 10 days from the decision to respond.

WHO PARTICIPATES?

All members of the team should be involved, regardless of hierarchy. Key staff of the Country Office even if not directly involved in the programme or project; key staff of the Regional Office and HQ, like the Crisis Response Unit, should participate. If relevant, include also experts, donors, key partners. Aim at a maximum of 10 people to keep the exercise manageable. Plan for note-taking and time-keeping.

HOW TO DO IT?

1. Planning

Plan for a meeting that can last 3-4 hours, ideally in person and if not possible via teleconference. Invite the attendees and share the agenda, at least 2 days in advance. Test communication and teleconference technology if it will be used.

Break up the programme or projects into parts (ex. phases or thematic areas of the response, as relevant), to have an organised and structured discussion. Identify lessons learned from similar projects.

Agenda (example)

09:00 – 09:05	Briefing on the project
09:05 – 09:20	Fiasco exercise
09:20 – 09:50	Record and prioritize risks
09:50 – 10:30	Analyze risks
10:30 – 10:45	Identify risk management measures
10:45 – 11:15	Discuss and prioritize risk management measures
11:15 – 11:30	Wrap-up and conclusion

2. Conduct the BAR

Brief the group on the programme or project (5 mins maximum). If more background information is needed, send it beforehand and ask participants to read it in advance.

Conduct the Fiasco exercise: ask participants to imagine a spectacular failure of the programme or project. Ask them to spend 10 minutes writing on sticky notes or VIPP cards all the reasons they can imagine for the failure, then stick them to the wall / flipchart. If there are participants online, ask them to share verbally, write down their reasons and stick them with the other ones.

Review the reasons and group similar ones; read out loud the risks (or groups of risks) identified. Ask participants to vote, with stickers or marks, on the 3/4 most important risks. If there are participants online, ask them to share verbally and do it for them. Participants should vote considering the likelihood of the risk and its severity and potential consequences. Once everyone has voted, identify the most voted risks or concerns (between 3 and 10 depending on the complexity of the project or programme).

List the top risks on the flipchart or white board and analyze them one by one.

First, categorize them (ex. Programme, programme support, funding, human resources, quality, performance, accountability, scope, partners, external environment etc.)

Then, ask what would cause the risk to happen.

Assess the likelihood on a scale from 1 to 5 (1-remote, 2-unlikely, 3-possible, 4-likely, 5-expected or almost expected to occur)

Assess the severity, what damage would it cause, what impact would it have on a scale from 1 to 3 (1-small damage, 2-moderate damage, 3-severe damage)

After the discussion on all of the top risks identified, ask participants to write on VIPP cards their ideas for mitigation of the risks, identifying at least one idea per risk. Place the cards next to the corresponding risk on the wall / flipchart. If there are participants online, ask them to share verbally and do it for them. Once everyone has finished, group the ideas and discuss together what solutions should be used or prioritized. Note that risks can be accepted, mitigated, transferred or eliminated.

Close the meeting and inform participants you will share immediately the results of the meeting, asking them to provide feedback within 24/48 hours

3. After the BAR

Capture the results of the BAR in writing and send to the participants; after 24/48 hours finalize the BAR report and share it with the participants and other relevant stakeholders. Use the BAR report during monitoring of the programme or project, during reviews and as an input during the After Action Review.

6.7. SURGE Plan

UNDP SURGE Plan

Response to Cyclone Pam

April to June 2015

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I- Context

Tropical Cyclone Pam struck Vanuatu on the evening of 13 March at around 11.00 p.m. local time. The country is an archipelago of more than 80 islands with a projected population of 270,000 people according to 2015 national statistics' office calculations. The category 5 cyclone caused widespread damage across all six provinces of the archipelago – Malampa, Penama, Sanma, Shefa, Tafea, and Torba. Tropical Cyclone Pam's eye passed close to Efate Island in Sefa Province, where the capital Port Vila is located, with winds around 250 km/hr and gusts peaking at 320 km/hr.

An estimated 166,600 people have been affected by the cyclone – more than half the country's population and 11 fatalities have been reported. Early warning systems and the provision of evacuation centers by the Government of Vanuatu (GoV) have prevented a higher death toll. Shefa and Tafea were the hardest hit provinces. In Tongoa, Emae and Erromango Islands, up to 90 per cent of shelters have been wiped out. In Tanna, 50 per cent of shelters have been destroyed. Roads are impassable as debris is still being cleared. Water and food have been identified as the most urgently needed commodities for affected people.

Although still dependent upon humanitarian relief, the communities have already started the process of repairing homes, clearing and paving roads and rebuilding their livelihoods. Vanuatu's population is highly reliant on subsistence farming for food security and livelihoods. The destruction of food gardens and loss of livestock has left households with no alternative food source. In Tafea and Shefa Provinces all crops have been damaged or destroyed and current estimates indicate that food sources will last until end March. The loss of food crops as well as coconut and banana plantations has destroyed the main source of income for the population. This will have a significant long term social and economic impact.

In Tuvalu, the human toll is 2 persons, and the cyclone has caused damage to infrastructure and crops, which are the main source of livelihood. The central islands of Nui, Vaitupu and Nukufetau indicate that life is normalising, with power returning, low prevalence of communicable diseases, sufficient water supplies and current food and fuel stocks adequate

to meet immediate needs. Medium- and long-term recovery measures will become increasingly important as relief supplies reach the islands. Agricultural recovery will be particularly important because of the almost total loss of crops and extensive loss of livestock.

II- UNDP Fiji MCO program and operational capacities in Vanuatu

The Fiji MCO works for 10 countries (Fiji, Federated State of Micronesia, Kiribati, Nauru, Palau, Republic of Marshall Islands, Solomon Islands, Tonga, Tuvalu, and Vanuatu). The Fiji MCO is led by an RC/RR who was designated HC after the onset of cyclone Pam for a period of three months. The MCO's delivery in the past three years has been respectively: 8,707,826 USD in 2012; 10,159,121 USD in 2013 and 14,131,524 USD in 2014.

Because of the need for a differentiated response, as well as to reduce transaction costs and increase impact, Fiji MCO focuses on the specific priority areas of each country and, where appropriate, adopts sub-regional/regional initiatives for more effective provision of development services. Decisions are based on shared characteristics such as similarity of resource bases, geographical similarity (atoll nations, for example) and income levels (such as least developed and middle-income countries). Country programme action plans reflect the country-specific priorities identified during the national consultation processes and in coordination with other United Nations organizations.

In Vanuatu a UN Joint Presence Office (JPO) is led by UNICEF. Prior to the disaster, there were only 4 UNDP staff including project staff in Vanuatu and only a Country Development Manager (CDM) in Tuvalu. The bulk of the program in Vanuatu revolves around climate change and disaster risk management programs. Following Cyclone Pam, and given the socio-economic impact the cyclone is expected to generate, there will be a need adapt the current projects focus and to tap on their presence to support communities with income and livelihoods generation. For an overview of project sites in Vanuatu, please see Annex 2. National Staff from VCAP (Vanuatu Climate Adaptation Programme), VCRP (Vanuatu Community Resilience Project) and PRRP (Pacific Risk Resilience Programme), as well as national program analyst are currently based in Port Vila. They will also be providing support to the inter-cluster assessment due to start right before Easter. For more information on synergies between existing projects in the MCO and the Pacific Center to help with the response to Cyclone Pam, please see Annex 3. As per the model of the MCO, operations staff based in Suva will continue to service UNDP in Vanuatu, with operations/logistics support and procurement staff rotating in and out of Port Vila on weekly basis, started from 22 March. In Tuvalu, the UN has a Country Development Manager, led by UNDP. A Recovery Adviser (MacDonald Kadzatsa) working with Fiji MCO/Pacific Center was deployed to Tuvalu on 19 March and re-assigned to spend the next three months in Tuvalu. Programme Coordinator of PRRP (Moortaza Jiwanji) was deployed to Vanuatu on 22 March for a week to work on UNDP recovery programming.

Summary of existing and pipeline projects

<i>Existing projects</i>	<i>New projects</i>
Vanuatu Climate Adaptation Programme (VCAP)	Cash for work Project Initiation Plan
Vanuatu Community Resilience Project (VCRP)	Cyclone Pam Recovery and Resilience Programme in Vanuatu (Joint Program)
Pacific Risk Resilience Programme (PRRP)	Recovery project in Tuvalu, including debris management (being prepared)
	Restoring LH in post TC Pam to increase coffee production in Tanna

Thanks to the deployment of a Recovery Advisor (see below), UNDP will develop its Recovery Vision and align its programs accordingly with the Joint Action Plan (see below).

III- Early Recovery Coordination

Following the cyclone, the GoV has expressed the need for a light needs assessment and has started already conducting its own assessment led by its respective ministries. The World Bank in coordination with the Prime Minister's Office agreed on conducting a light PDNA (Post-Disaster Needs Assessment) based on the DALA (Damage and Loss Assessment). On the other hand, the Humanitarian Country Team will go ahead with a MIRA II (Multi-Cluster Initial Rapid Assessment) inter-cluster assessment in order to update the Flash Appeal. The two assessments will be combined into a Joint Action Plan (JAP). The Government of Vanuatu intends to use the findings of the parallel assessments to produce a nationally owned Recovery Plan by the end of April 2015. UNDP will join both assessments by focusing on livelihoods and early recovery activities. There are concerns about the government's absorption capacity of big assessments, but also about duplication of these assessments. It is expected that early recovery will feature as the major need of these assessments, for the immediate and longer term. The outcome of these assessments is meant to inform the Joint Program design finalization, Cyclone Pam Recovery and Resilience Program (CPRRP).³⁷ While the cluster system was already set up in Vanuatu before the crisis, it did not include Early Recovery. It is envisaged that following the JAP and the Vanuatu Recovery Plan, the Government will establish an Economic Recovery Cluster. It has yet to be discussed whether Early Recovery will be part of this cluster or its own cluster. It should be noted that, other Agencies Funds and Programs (AFPs) are directly building in recovery into their mandate, i.e. recovery of schools.

Given that the Humanitarian Coordinator/Resident Coordinator (HC/RC) has the lead responsibility for ensuring that early recovery issues are adequately integrated in the humanitarian programme cycle³⁸ at country level in cooperation with national actors, UNDP will field a SURGE Recovery Advisor and a Cluster Coordinator to assist the Resident Coordination functions by linking early recovery to the broader recovery agenda, (e.g. through identification of strategic entry points for building sustainable institutions and systems); and will contribute to the work of the Country Team in strengthening national authorities and partners, as well as delivering coherently on Early Recovery.

IV- Resource mobilization

On March 24th the Flash Appeal for Vanuatu was launched aiming to mobilize almost 30,000,000 USD. Of this amount only 2.3 million USD are appealed for Early Recovery of which 1.9 million USD are for UNDP submissions supporting community infrastructure; debris clearance; Livelihoods for youth and women and early warning for seasonal hazards to reduce livelihood losses. The Flash Appeal is 36% funded as of 6 April. UNDP has submitted "time critical debris management and rehabilitation of community infrastructure in areas affected by cyclone Pam" proposals to the CERF; however, UNDP project was not included in the final submission to NY, being "not in line with CERF criteria". It should be noted that as the human loss for this cyclone has been minimal (11), media attention has faded quickly. Despite the cyclone having a significant long term social and economic impact, UNDP did not mobilize

The Joint Program will be implemented in partnership with ILO, UNV, UN Women, and UN Habitat

³⁸ The humanitarian programme cycle refers to a series of actions undertaken in the management of humanitarian programmes: assessment, planning, resource allocation, implementation, monitoring, reporting and evaluation.

resources via the Flash Appeal or the CERF as its submission was not deemed to include life-saving activities.

Major donors for this crisis include neighboring countries group of FRANZ (France, Australia, New-Zealand), as well as Japan and China. **The window for resource mobilization will be short and the funding pledges for the response are not expected to be substantial.** The Government of Vanuatu intends to present its Economic Recovery Plan at a donors' conference by the end of April/beginning of May 2015.

So far, RBAP released 50,000 USD for the MCO to respond to the crisis. TRAC 1.1.3 allocation of 350,000 USD was released for the MCO to conduct assessment and coordinate response to the crisis. By the time of the third Crisis Board, BPPS Bureau Project Appraisal Committee (BPAC) had endorsed a Project Initiation Plan (PIP) for Cash for Work, providing an allocation of 476,664 USD. The cash for work activities are extracted from the CPRRP. While the Program is still being finalized, these activities need to be rolled-out immediately to communities that have lost all livelihoods and sources of income. The PIP will also allow the CPRRP to adapt to the evolving realities on the ground and contribute to the finalization of the CPRRP. The funding received by BBPS is catalytic in allowing to demonstrate to donors UNDP's capacity to respond to crises in a timely manner, which in its turn should help the CPRRP mobilize resources. Thus cash for work via debris removal activities, are part of the wider CPRRP, which will Restore community and local government infrastructure; restore of livelihoods of women vendors and vulnerable households in informal settlements; provide work opportunities to young people in five most affected islands; and increase the resilience of communities against future cyclones and climate related disasters through community based disaster risk management.

The Fiji MCO is also preparing for the submission of a similar proposal to the BPPS BPAC for Tuvalu. UNDP is still following up with the Government of Japan on submission of proposals to the supplementary budget after the summer. The Fiji MCO plans to develop proposals for GCF.

Once exiting programs are aligned and new programs are finalized the Country Office will develop its resource mobilization strategy in order to deliver on its Recovery Vision.

V- SURGE Plan April to June 2015

Immediately following Cyclone Pam, UNDP was able to send a team of first responders to support the CO. The team includes two recovery advisors; debris removal expert and communications and program specialists. The team has provided support to draft Flash Appeal submission, as well as CERF and a Joint Recovery Program with UN Women; UN Habitat; ILO and UNV. The team has also support the RC/HC/RR and the DRR with guidance on positioning UNDP in the humanitarian response and post disasters assessments; represented UNDP in response meetings; and are expected to participate in humanitarian and livelihood assessments due to take place shortly in the archipelago.

First Responders to Cyclone Pam

Name	Function	Deliverable	Duration	Costs
Zubair Murshed	DRR/Recovery Advisor	Flash Appeal, CERF, Joint Program	2 weeks from 19 Mar. 15	13,631.79
Karen Bernard	DRR/Recovery Advisor	PDNA and MIRA Assessments	4 weeks from 27 Mar. 15	27,263.58

Tim Walsh	Debris Removal Expert	Jump start Cash for Work activities	4 weeks from 23 Mar. 15	27,263.58
Silke Von Brockhausen	Communications Specialist	Visibility of RC/HC and MCO on Early Recovery	6 weeks from 27 Mar. 15	40,895.38
Asmaa Shalabi	Program Specialist	SURGE Plan, Crisis response coordination	2.5 weeks from 27 Mar. 15	17,039.74
TOTAL:				126,094.07
Total cost proposed to be charged to the SURGE				98,830.49
Total cost proposed to be charged to MSB				27,263.58

Based on the above analysis it is expected that UNDP will need to position itself as the leader in Early Recovery in a very short time span and in a context limited pledges and resources. Thus this SURGE plan mainly focuses on programmatic needs pertaining to Early Recovery and debris removal in Vanuatu and Tuvalu. The aim will be to position UNDP Fiji MCO to position itself and to build the necessary portfolio that will respond to recovery needs of the affected communities.

SURGE Response Team for Cyclone Pam

DESCRIPTION	SURGE 3 MONTHS		Medium-term vision 12 M	
Programme:	Total amount in US\$	Fund	Months	Funding Source
7. Debris Management Advisor - Port Vila (P4)	81,790.75	MSB		
8.				
9. Recovery Project Manager - Port Vila (P4)	81,790.75	TRAC1.1.3	9	Project
10. Debris Management & Recovery Advisor - Tuvalu (P4)	81,790.75	MSB		
11. NOA Procurement Analyst*	35,218.00	Project		
12. ER Cluster Coordinator and Advisor (P5, 1 month)	28,430.25	SURGE		
13. Recovery Advisor – Port Vila (P4)	81,790.75	SURGE		
Sub-Total Programme Cost:	390,811.25			
RC Office				
1. UN Coordination Specialist (P3)	73,601.50	SURGE		
Sub-Total UN Coordination Cost:	73,601.50			
TOTAL:				464,412.75
Total cost proposed to be charged to the SURGE				183,822.50
Total cost proposed to be charged to the Project budget/CO and MSB				280,590.25

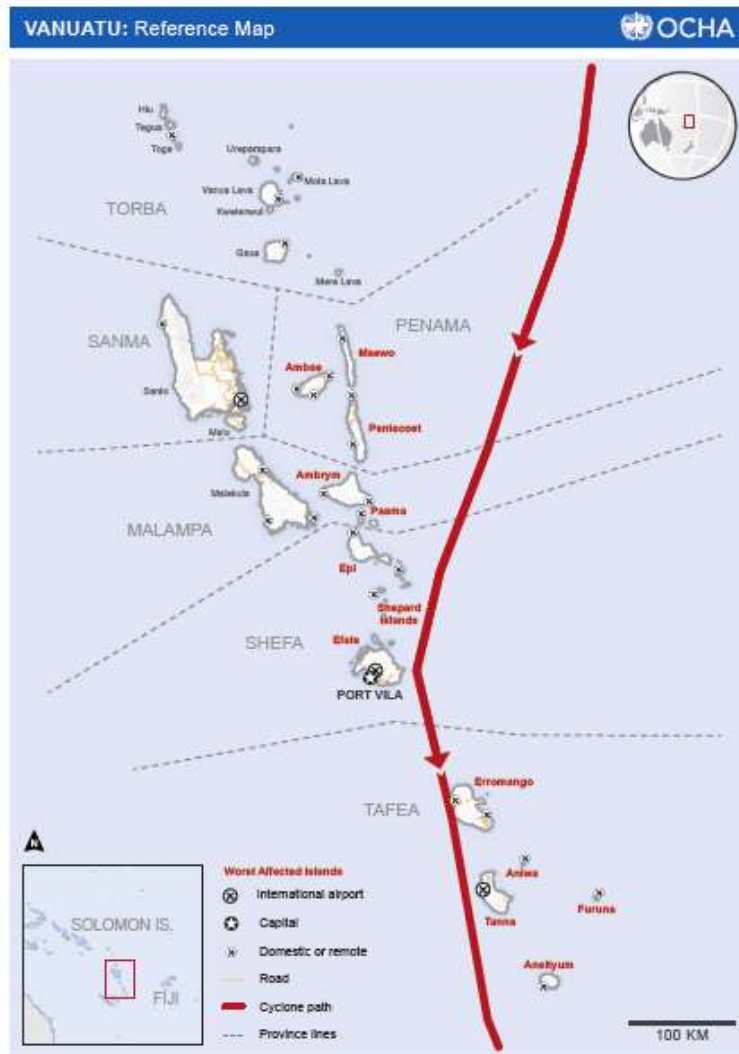
*Depending on load of work

As their deployments expire, the first responders will hand over to the SURGE Team described in the SURGE table above. It is expected that the Debris Management Advisors will take over from the Debris Removal and Recovery Expert and roll-out the activities in additional locations. The Recovery Project Manager will finalize the CPRRP, ensure liaison and coordination with partner agencies, and mobilize resources for the Cyclone Pam Recovery and Resilience Program. The Communications Specialist will make sure UNDP Recovery work gets visibility among the UN family and beyond by working closely with RC/HC/RR and other agencies. The Program Specialist, will ensure the finalization of a SURGE plan, deployment of the SURGE capacity and make sure first responders and SURGE capacity are best used to position UNDP in this crisis. Following the three months SURGE phase UNDP Fiji MCO should have mobilized resources and recruited the needed capacity to sustainably run early recovery programs in the Vanuatu and Tuvalu. Given the substantive mobilization by UN Agencies, Funds and Programs to support with relief and recovery efforts in response to Cyclone Pam, the Coordination Specialists will support the RC/HC/RR in aligning the UN family internally and vis a vis external counterparts.

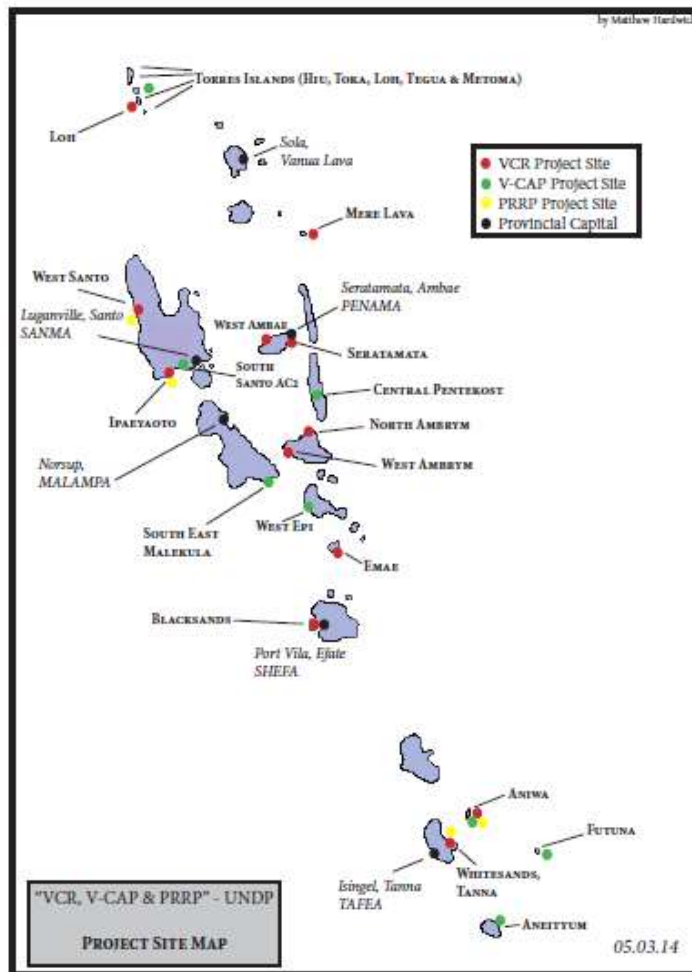
The SURGE Staff will work closely with existing staff under the VCAP, VCRP and PRRP and liaise with them on the implementation of activities where these projects are already active. They teams are expected to jointly report to the D/RR based in Suva. The national Programme Analyst (NoB) is being asked to perform the Vanuatu office management in addition to his regular programme management tasks. The MCO is processing the reclassification of the post to match the actual work being tasked and the TOR/post. The temporary Programme/Operations Associate will be matrix managed by the Programme Analyst (and by ARRs in Suva).

To accommodate the new capacity, UNDP Fiji MCO has rented a bigger space in the JPO facility for 12 months, where all programs can now sit and work together. This includes the 4 UNDP staff who were on board before the cyclone, a driver and 3 additional SURGE staff.

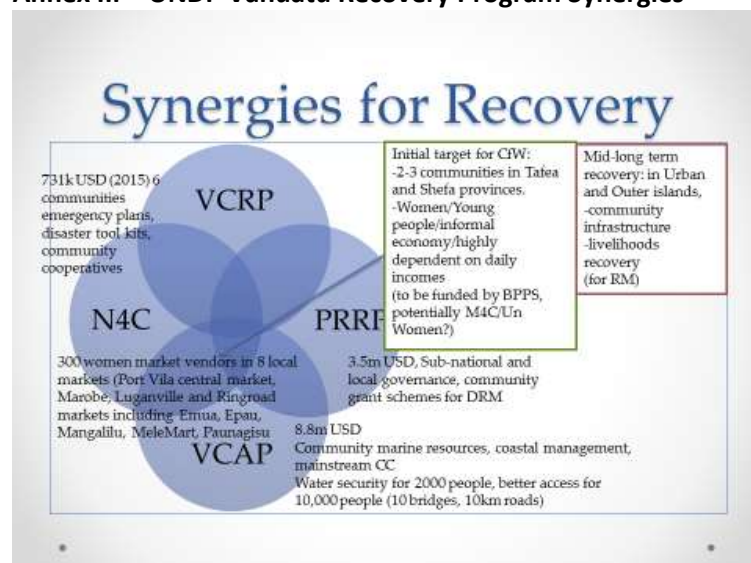
Annex I – Map of Vanuatu –



Annex II – UNDP Project sites in Vanuatu



Annex III – UNDP Vanuatu Recovery Program Synergies



6.8. CB Minutes

Minutes of the first UNDP Crisis Board Meeting on the Pacific Response to Cyclone Pam

1. Date and time: 08:00 Tuesday 17 March, BKK time, 13:00 Suva time, 21:00 Monday NY time
2. Participants:

Chair:	Nicholas Rosellini, RBAP
Fiji MCO/Pacific Center:	Osnat Lubrani, Peter Batchelor, Akiko Suzaki, Asenaca Ravuvu, Elena Wakolo, Moortaza Jiwanji, MacDonald Kadzatsa
Bangkok Regional Hub:	Vineet Bhatia, Devanand Ramiah, Sanny Ramos Jegillos, Krishna Vatsa, Peter Waa, Mark Richmond, Cedric Monteiro, Douglas Hageman, Ram Iyer, Naoko Takasu
RBAP New York:	Elena Tischenko, Sitara Syed
CRU New York:	Bruno Lemarquis, Rebecca Reynolds
BPPS New York:	Stan Nkwain, Owen Shumba, Rossana Dudziak, Rita Missal, Yasumitsu Doken
BERA New York:	Gulden Turkoz-Cosslett, Jelena Vladicic
BOM New York:	Luc Vandamme
3. Key decisions/follow-up points:
 - (a) Level of crisis: Agreed with Level 2 Crisis
 - (b) Urgency/importance of advocating UNDP message and ensuring early recovery fully included in the appeal was highlighted; key lessons learned from the Philippines is that once we miss resource mobilization opportunity, there is no second round. Therefore there is need to develop programming proposals quickly.
 - (c) Next CBM will be either Monday 23 March or Tuesday 24 March, same time. It will look into more details on additional human resource or other (e.g. communications equipment) needs; thus Fiji MCO/Pacific Center need to identify gaps and requirements by next meeting.
 - (d) RBAP will provide USD50,000 to Fiji MCO for immediate expenses.
 - (e) BOM is requested to advise on: (i) needed support to affected national staff, e.g. salary advance and (ii) Procurement Fast Track approval (RBAP supports the Fiji MCO request for Fast Track specifically for Vanuatu and Tuvalu related programmes and activities).
 - (f) Fiji MCO/Pacific Center to submit: (i) A consolidated TRAC 3 proposal covering Vanuatu, Tuvalu and Solomon Islands (if needed) by Thursday 19 March and (ii) two pagers on key needs and requirements for Tokyo as requested by BERA by Friday, 20 March.
 - (g) Communications: Important for UNDP to communicate what it intends to do as soon as possible. BERA/Communications, Stano and Cedric to work with MCO/PC on this.
 - (h) CRU will expedite OCHA's designation of Osnat as Humanitarian Coordinator.
4. Other key points discussed/raised:

- (a) Osnat: Flying to Vanuatu on Wednesday 18 March. All 3 UNDP staff based in Vanuatu accounted for, but they are affected and need support. UNDP stronger presence on the ground is a key to mobilize resources and implement projects. A need to keep the Vanuatu Government in a driving seat was highlighted. Absorptive capacity of the Government and transportation to remote islands are the challenge.
- (b) UNDP MCO and PC will quickly review ongoing programmes and projects in the two countries (Vanuatu and Tuvalu) with a view to re-orient activities and resource allocations, human and financial, to meet the new post cyclone scenario.
- (c) It would be a good idea to already pre-position human and physical assets as may be required in Suva (using SURGE and other funding) so that deployment will be quick and responsive to emerging needs. After a time, this will be reviewed, and can be deactivated if the need is no longer anticipated. The Fiji MCO/PC to determine feasibility of this approach and revert.
- (d) Peter: SURGE Advisor Zubair Murshed will arrive Suva on Thursday 19 March. MacDonald Kadzatsa is going to Tuvalu on Thursday. MCO/PC will get back on specific additional human resource needs shortly, but probably programming (designing projects and drafting proposals) and regional humanitarian coordination support may be required.
- (e) Rapid assessments or a PDNA will be required, but it is important that assessments by the donor community are coordinated so that the government is not overwhelmed by having to deal with each donor separately.

Minutes of the second UNDP Crisis Board Meeting on the Pacific Response to Cyclone Pam

- 5. Date and time: 08:00 Tue 24 Mar 2015 BKK, 12:00 Port Vila, 13:00 Suva, 21:00 Mon 23 Mar NY
- 6. Participants:

Chair:	Nicholas Rosellini, RBAP
Fiji MCO/Pacific Center:	Osnat Lubrani, Peter Batchelor, Akiko Fujii, Asenaca Ravuvu, Elena Wakolo, Sheryl Ho
Bangkok Regional Hub:	Caitlin Wiesen, Vineet Bhatia, Devanand Ramiah, Peter Waa, Tomislav Condic, Cedric Monteiro, Douglas Hageman, Ram Iyer, Carsten Hansen, Rajesh Sharma, Naoko Takasu
RBAP New York:	Elena Tischenko, Sitara Syed
CRU New York:	Bettina Woll
BPPS New York:	Stan Nkwain, Rita Missal, Yasumitsu Doken
BERA New York:	Gülden Türköz-Cosslett, Jelena Vladicic
BOM New York:	Notonegoro
- 7. Key decisions/follow-up points:
 - (i) Priority in programme design and implementation was highlighted.
 - (j) PDNA: A concern on the World Bank moving ahead with PDNA without involving UNDP and EU was highlighted, and BERA or CRU will raise to Washington DC after Osnat's meetings with WB and EU in Vanuatu.

- (k) Seed funding from BPPS: A project document needs to be formulated and submitted as quickly as possible.
 - (l) Immediate HR needs have been tabled and taken note as follows:
 - (1) Vanuatu: Senior Recovery Advisor for 3 months
 - (2) Tuvalu: Senior Recovery Advisor who knows UNDP and can also handle UN coordination for potential Flash Appeal for 3 months
 - (3) Vanuatu and Suva: Programme Specialist to prepare and implement Flash Appeal project on recovery (UN Joint Programme)
 - (4) Vanuatu: UNDP Head of Office to also cover representation, donor relations, inter-agency etc. and help establish UNDP office for 3 -6 months, to be converted into regular post funded from recovery projects in the future
 - (5) Tuvalu: Debris Management Specialist (3-4 weeks) (can be consultant or from roster)
 - (6) Suva: Detailed assignment to support MCO programmes in remaining 8 countries
 - (m) SURGE Plan: A comprehensive plan linking inputs and outputs needs to be tabled to the Crisis Board, if possible, at next Crisis Board meeting.
 - (n) CERF proposal: CERF request from Vanuatu will be sent in 3 days; UNDP needs to be involved.
 - (o) Immediate deployment from BRH: Francisco Santos-Padron, Programme Advisor on Livelihoods will be deployed to Vanuatu as soon as the starting date is confirmed by Fiji MCO.
 - (p) Next CBM is tentatively scheduled on Tuesday 31 March, same time.
8. Other key points discussed/raised:
- (f) Actions taken after the first CBM:
 - (1) Early Recovery has duly incorporated in the Flash Appeal which will be launched at 3pm on Tue 24 March in Port Vila by the Prime Minister of Vanuatu.
 - (2) RBAP released USD50,000 to Fiji MCO for immediate expenses.
 - (3) BOM coordinated with other UN Agencies on support for affected staff, and Fast Track Procedure has been approved.
 - (4) TRAC-3 proposal of USD350,000 for 3 countries (Vanuatu, Tuvalu and Kiribati) was submitted, approved, and ASL has been allocated.
 - (5) 2-pagers for the Government of Japan have been prepared and shared to Tokyo Office.
 - (6) A short story with photos from Tuvalu uploaded on website, and another story on Flash Appeal launch will be uploaded today (24 March). A blog from Moortaza is also expected.
 - (7) Osnat has been designated as Humanitarian Coordinator on 17 March 2015.
 - (g) BERA: On resource mobilization, not yet heard back from Tokyo Office on the proposal. Australian is keen to support; engagement with local embassy is encouraged. For New Zealand, BERA will be happy to solicit with the Permanent Mission in New York, if the proposal is given.

Minutes of the third UNDP Crisis Board Meeting on the Pacific Response to Cyclone Pam

9. Date and time: 08:00 Wed 1 Apr 2015 BKK, 13:00 Suva, 21:00 Tue 31 Mar NY

10. Participants:

Chair:	Nicholas Rosellini, RBAP
Fiji MCO/Pacific Center:	Osnat Lubrani, Peter Batchelor, Akiko Fujii, Asenaca Ravuvu, Elena Wakolo, Sheryl Ho, Ruth Verevukivuki
Bangkok Regional Hub:	Caitlin Wiesen, Vineet Bhatia, Devanand Ramiah, Sanny Ramos Jegillos, Tomislav Condic, Cedric Monteiro, Ram Iyer, Carsten Hansen, Naoko Takasu
RBAP New York:	Elena Tischenko, Sitara Syed
CRU New York:	Bruno Lemarquis, Bettina Woll
BPPS New York:	Stan Nkwain, Rita Missal, Owen Shumba, Krishna Vatsa, Yasumitsu Doken
BERA New York:	Nick Rene Hartmann, Jelena Vladicic
BOM New York:	Notonegoro, Sara Wolde-Aregay

11. Key decisions/follow-up points:

- (q) SURGE Plan: Approved subject to a revision incorporating comments received during the meeting
- (r) Resource mobilization: Fiji MCO to develop and share concept notes to solicit bilateral donors to BERA, utilizing documents prepared for Flash Appeal, CERF proposal, Joint Programme, etc.
- (s) PDNA: Fiji MCO to reflect findings in Joint Programme. BPPS to take up recurring issues with the World Bank.
- (t) Working level crisis management team: To be established, and coherent/streamlined internal communications are requested
- (u) GEF mission to the Pacific (scheduled 27 Apr – 8 May) postponement: Caitlin to liaise with Adriana/Gordon
- (v) CERF proposal: UNDP proposal was not included in the final submission to the Emergency Relief Coordinator, as it was not considered as “in line with CERF criteria” while similar proposals were included in other countries. CRU to liaise with OCHA to avoid same situation in the future and ensure a revised/updated Flash Appeal will highlight Early Recovery.
- (w) Support to Tuvalu: Fiji MCO to submit another PIP for BPPS seed funding consideration
- (x) Early recovery programme: components on longer term livelihoods restoration (beyond debris clearance and Cash for Work) and service delivery by local governments should be included.

12. Other key points discussed/raised:

- (h) Deep appreciation expressed from RBAP and Fiji MCO to BPPS and CRU for their prompt actions and supports given so far, including seed funding (USD476,664) approval and allocation based on the Project Initiation Plan (PIP) “Vanuatu Cash-for-Work and Debris Clearance Initiative” submitted by Fiji MCO.
- (i) HC/RC/RR updates included:
 - (1) Vanuatu will have a Presidential election this year (2015);
 - (2) HC/RC/RR will be back to Vanuatu from 6 April for 1 week;

- (3) The second phase of assessment will be completed shortly and findings will be reflected in revised/updated Flash Appeal;
- (4) HC/RC/RR will conduct outreach to donors based in Vanuatu/Fiji as well as EU taking opportunity to go to Brussels after the Chief Executives Board meeting in Paris;
- (5) Accreditation of UNDP as an Implementing Entity for Green Climate Fund is an opportunity to mobilize a large amount for resilience building in the Pacific;
- (6) The Government of Vanuatu insisted to do PDNA quickly and sent an official request letter on 31 March; the assessment will start from 6 April, and Karen Bernard from UNDP will join. (The letter and draft TOR have been shared after the meeting);
- (7) As the impact of Tropical Cyclone Pam in Tuvalu is still being assessed, a proposal for seed funding for Tuvalu will be prepared and shared in coming days, as mentioned to HC/RC/RR email to BPPS Director on Monday 30 March; and
- (8) Federated States of Micronesia (FSM) hit by another cyclone (Typhoon Maysak), and the Government may ask for UN support.
- (j) Major comments on the SURGE plan were as follows:
 - (8) A well written document;
 - (9) Narrative for each position and linkage with PIP/Joint Programme should be added;
 - (10) Procurement/Operations support position in Vanuatu/Suva (even on detail assignment) should be added with caveat that programme funds will be mobilized; and
 - (11) A total requirement for Debris Management Advisors was not clear. There should be a reference to First Responders / SURGE personnel who were already in the Plan to ensure clarity and comprehensive picture.

Minutes of the fourth UNDP Crisis Board Meeting on the Pacific Response to Cyclone Pam

13. Date and time: 08:00 Fri 10 Apr 2015 BKK, 13:00 Suva, 21:00 Thu 9 Apr NY

14. Participants:

Chair:	Nicholas Rosellini, RBAP
Fiji MCO/Pacific Center:	Osnat Lubrani, Akiko Fujii, Asenaca Ravuvu, Elena Wakolo, Sheryl Ho, Moortaza Jiwani, Ruth Verevukivuki, Asmaa Shalabi
Bangkok Regional Hub:	Caitlin Wiesen, Devanand Ramiah, Sanny Ramos Jegillos, Francisco Santos-Padron, Cedric Monteiro, Carsten Hansen, Naoko Takasu
RBAP New York:	Elena Tischenko, Sitara Syed
CRU New York:	Bettina Woll
BPPS New York:	Stan Nkwain, Rita Missal, Owen Shumba
BERA New York:	Nick Rene Hartmann, Jelena Vladicic
BOM New York:	Notonegoro, Sara Wolde-Aregay

15. Key decisions/follow-up points:

- (y) **Provision of substantive support:** The point on the need to position UNDP on the long term recovery issues were acknowledged. In this regard it was agreed to deploy both Sanny and Francisco from BRH/BPPS to ensure UNDP positioning in Early Recovery and livelihoods as foundation for long term recovery as well as to support the PDNA. It was agreed that the rural electrification project/Nationally Appropriate Mitigation Actions (NAMA) needs to be aligned with the recovery efforts, and the mission from the Energy Advisor of BPPS to be closely coordinated with the rest of the crisis response efforts.
- (z) **Programme development:** One of the key tasks of the deployment of Sanny and Francisco will be to finalize the programming documents (incl. UNDP recovery vision paper) as well as respond to the Government's request for technical advice on Economic Recovery. They will also help the CO finalize the 2 page summary documents that can be used for resource mobilization.
- (aa) **Resource mobilization:** BERA will organize a high-level meeting with Permanent Representatives in New York. Nick and Jo will use an opportunity of meetings with EU next week, to be followed up with Osnat during her visit to Brussels towards the end of April/early May. Coordination through BERA's Brussels Representation Office should be ensured.
- (bb) **Support to Tuvalu:** BPPS to provide feedback to draft Project Initiation Plan (PIP) document shared from Fiji MCO.
- (cc) **Joint Programme Document:** Fiji MCO/SURGE/First Responders to ensure incorporating comments from BPPS/RPPS.
- (dd) **SURGE Plan:** Fiji MCO to finalize incorporating today's deployment decision and submit to CRU.
- (ee) **Next CBM:** Before 23 April, to be determined/communicated.

16. Other key points discussed/raised:

- (k) Final draft of Joint Humanitarian Action Plan will be presented to the Government on 21 April and to be launched on 23 April. A donor forum or briefing to donors will be organized.
- (l) It was pointed out that UNDP has already invested approx. USD1 million from its own resources for Cyclone Pam response both for programming and surge response; and the window of opportunities is quickly closing; thus the resource mobilization efforts needs to take priority.

Minutes of the fifth UNDP Crisis Board Meeting on the Pacific Response to Cyclone Pam

17. Date and time: 08:00 Fri 24 Apr 2015 BKK, 13:00 Suva, 21:00 Thu 23 Apr NY

18. Participants:

Chair:	Nicholas Rosellini, RBAP
Fiji MCO/Pacific Center:	Akiko Fujii, Peter Batchelor, Sanny Ramos Jegillos
Bangkok Regional Hub:	Caitlin Wiesen, Devanand Ramiah, Shairi Mathur, Cedric Monteiro, Naoko Takasu
RBAP New York:	Elena Tischenko, Sitara Syed
CRU New York:	Bettina Woll

BPPS New York:	Stan Nkwain, Rita Missal, Owen Shumba, Krishna Vatsa, Yasumitsu Doken
BERA New York:	Nick Rene Hartmann, Jelena Vladicic
BOM New York:	Sara Wolde-Aregay

19. Key decisions/follow-up points:

- (ff) **Programme development:** Fiji MCO to finalize the Joint Programme document (timeline to be determined.) BPPS to hold a separate teleconference with Fiji MCO to finalize the Project Initiation Plan for Tuvalu.
- (gg) **Resource mobilization:** BERA to organize a briefing meeting with Permanent Representatives from potential donors including Kuwait as well as Vanuatu and Tuvalu in New York and disseminate UNDP funding proposal. BERA/CRU to provide advice to Fiji MCO on possible funding modality for Joint Programme from DFAT of Australia. Osnat and BERA to work with Brussels Office to take an opportunity of the Administrator visit to Brussels in the week of 27 April to solicit funding from EU.
- (hh) **SURGE Plan:** BRH agreed to extend Francisco deployment. Fiji MCO to confirm project funds for Procurement Analyst for CRU to deploy.
- (ii) **CBM:** Regular Crisis Board Meetings were completed today and ad-hoc meeting will be held if/when requested by Fiji MCO or HQ.

20. Other key points discussed/raised (including written inputs from Sanny and Silke in Vanuatu after the meeting):

- (m) **UNDP programme implementation:** On 21 April, Fiji MCO launched implementation of the Vanuatu Cash for Work and Debris Clearance project funded by BPPS in partnership with Department of Local Authorities. Through ongoing Vanuatu Community Resilience programme, solar lanterns were procured and handed to the communities as a part of the Emergency Kit which have been distributed to the 12 project sites in Vanuatu.

(n) **Vanuatu Planning Frameworks:**

- I. The Humanitarian Action Plan (HAP) was completed with revision from the Flash Appeal and submitted to the government of Vanuatu. The total cost is increased based on recent assessment findings that there are more affected households that was originally determined.
- II. The PDNA report (summary, narrative and power point) was completed and Karen Bernard who took the lead role for the UN/UNDP is completing her detailed assignment today and will return to Equatorial Guinea. It was presented to the Prime Minister and his Ministers on 23 April and there was endorsement that the damage and loss assessment is a credible report. There were lots of discussion and lack of conclusion on the needs assessment and recommendations.
- III. The Prime Minister's Office (PMO) will consider both reports in the next few days and Osnat spoke with them for an early release and announcement of the findings of the report. Most donors are very keen on the results of these reports both from humanitarian and development financing perspective.
- IV. There is lack of confirmation on how the Prime Minister's office will move forward on the release of the report and the development of the recovery plan. An official offer of support for technical advisory services from UNDP from Osnat was received by the PMO and BRH advisors (Sanny and Francisco)

are involved. The possibility of the launch of the Socio Economic Recovery Plan (unofficial title) of the Government was discussed between Osnat and PMO indicating that this could happen during Haoliang's visit in Port Vila (15-19 May) including field visit.

- (o) **Tuvalu:** SURGE UN Coordination Specialist will arrive next week. The Government of Tuvalu is planning to prepare a National Post-Disaster Recovery Plan.
- (p) **Resource mobilization efforts on the ground:** Osnat and Akiko had meetings with Australia, New Zealand, EU, and Japan in Port Vila and Suva. DFAT is keen in supporting livelihoods restoration and community infrastructure rehabilitation, but it will not be through emergency funding window but through development window. Concerned Ministries/Department of the Government of Vanuatu has been consulted with contents of UNDP proposal; however, as the Government of Vanuatu has strong ownership in its recovery process, we have to be mindful when we approach donor and ensure that UN/UNDP work is to support the Government.
- (q) **Communication:** The need for early recovery and UNDP's role in the response have been documented on UNDP and UN websites, social media in English, French and Spanish, through photo stories, an infographic, a blog, and have been highlighted in several press releases. The HC/RC/RR and other UNDP staff have given numerous background briefings and radio interviews (ABC Radio, Radio Australia, UN Radio) on rebuilding livelihoods after the Cyclone, starting this week on cash-for-work. Local and global press (Reuters, AP) has covered UNDP's work in Vanuatu widely; it was also mentioned in several media briefings of the Secretary-General.

6.9. Fiji MCO (now Pacific Office in Fiji) Structure

The information below is taken from UNDP's website

http://www.pacific.undp.org/content/pacific/en/home/operations/about_undp.html

Ms Osnat Lubrani, UNDP Resident Representative and UN Resident Coordinator

Ms Akiko Fujii, Country Director

Ms Azusa Kubota, Country Director - Solomon Islands

Ms Asenaca Ravuvu, Assistant Resident Representative - Programmes

Ms Elena Wakolo, Assistant Resident Representative - Operations

The Resident Representative for UNDP also serves as the Resident Coordinator for the United Nations system in the 10 Pacific Island countries.

There are two Country Directors – Ms Azusa Kubota who oversees the Solomon Islands and Ms Akiko Fujii who oversees the Federated States of Micronesia, Fiji, Kiribati, Marshall Islands, Nauru, Palau, Tonga, Tuvalu and Vanuatu. There are two Assistant Representatives for Programmes and Operations.

The UNDP Pacific Office in Fiji is responsible for the merged functions for UNDP country programming in the ten countries, which was covered by the Fiji-based Multi-Country Office, and regional programming and provision of technical advisory services by the Pacific Centre to the 15 Pacific countries, including those covered by the Samoa based Multi-Country office and the PNG Country Office. The UNDP Pacific - Solomon Islands Office, now headed by a Country Manager, remains the same with stronger technical and operational connections with the UNDP Pacific Office in Fiji.